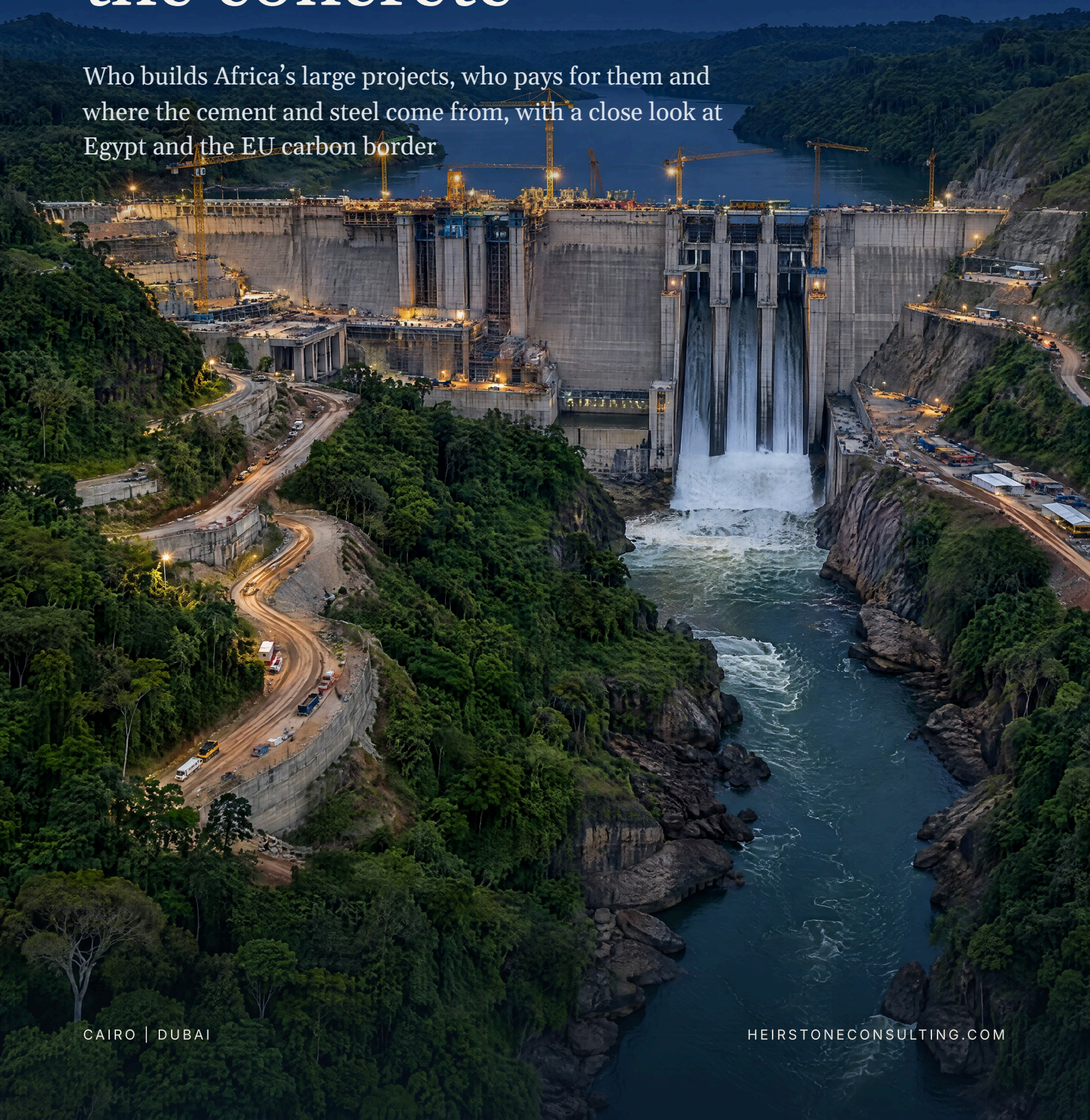
HEIRSTONE CONSULTING

HEIRSTONE CONSULTING RESEARCH | 2026

CONTRACTORS AND BUILDING MATERIALS

# Who pours the concrete

Who builds Africa's large projects, who pays for them and where the cement and steel come from, with a close look at Egypt and the EU carbon border



CAIRO | DUBAI

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## THE REPORT IN SIX NUMBERS

**61.6%** of the African revenue of ENR's Top 250 international contractors went to Chinese firms in 2024: about US$32.5bn of US$52.7bn

**93%** fall in Chinese loan commitments to Africa between the 2016 peak and 2024; Chinese contracting revenue in Africa fell about 31% from its own peak

**43.7%** of the large African projects Deloitte tracked in 2021 were built by private domestic firms and consortiums, against 27.1% by Chinese firms

**72%** of Elsewedy Electric's EGP 293bn (about US$6.2bn) construction order book lay outside Egypt at the end of 2025

**63%** of Côte d'Ivoire's 4.65 Mt of clinker imports came from Egypt in 2024

**74.6%** of the EU's 14.2 Mt of imported cement and clinker came from Türkiye, Egypt, Algeria, Tunisia and Morocco in 2025, the last year before the carbon border charge

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## ABOUT THIS REPORT

Heirstone Consulting advises developers, investors, development finance institutions and governments across the Middle East and Africa. This report draws on public sources current in 2026: ENR rankings as reported, Deloitte's Africa Construction Trends, the Boston University Chinese Loans to Africa Database, Turkish contracting statistics, company filings and releases, UN Comtrade data through World Bank WITS, Eurostat Comext, worldsteel, the US Geological Survey and the European Commission.

Where we combine published figures to produce a new one, such as a share, a value per kilometre or a carbon charge per tonne, the calculation is shown and labelled Heirstone analysis. Local-currency values carry a US dollar equivalent and the rate used.

## THE ARGUMENT

When one country's lender pays for an African project, a builder from that country usually builds it, as in all eight such projects in our 60-project Ledger. With Chinese state lending down about 93% from its peak, more contracts are paid for by African budgets, development banks and contractor-arranged finance, and are open to builders who bring finance, speed, local presence and materials. Egypt's contractors and producers fit that description, and on our scenarios the EU carbon border could send more Mediterranean materials towards Africa.

WHAT WE FOUND

# Tied loans once decided who built many of Africa's large projects. As they shrink, contractors win on a wider mix of money.

Chinese firms still earn about three of every five dollars that international contractors make in Africa. What has changed is who pays, and the change rewards builders who bring finance, speed, local presence and materials of their own.

1 **The market is growing slowly and China's share has stopped rising.**

ENR's Top 250 international contractors earned US$48.27bn in Africa in 2020 and about US$52.7bn in 2024. Chinese firms' share of that revenue rose from about 10% in 2002 to about half by 2014 and was 61 to 62% in each year reported since 2019.

2 **The money has changed more than the builders.**

Chinese loan commitments to Africa fell about 93% from the 2016 peak to about US$2.1bn in 2024; Chinese contracting revenue fell about 31% from its 2015 peak. In Deloitte's 2021 count, governments funded 31.4% of large projects and China 10.6%, and local firms and consortiums built 43.7%.

3 **In the Ledger, tied loans went to the lender's own builders; open money was contestable.**

In the 60-project Heirstone Africa Builders Ledger, all eight projects financed by a lender tied to one country went to a builder from that country. The seven paid for by development banks, African budgets, a commercial loan or the client went to builders of four nationalities, three of them to Egyptian firms.

4 **Egypt's contractors have become exporters.**

Elsewedy Electric holds 72% of its EGP 293bn (US$6.2bn) construction order book outside Egypt, and Petrojet signed 60% of its 2024 contracts abroad. Orascom Construction (US$5.05bn of 2025 revenue, US$9.0bn order book) ranks eighth in Africa in ENR's 2026 ranking. The Egyptian-led Julius Nyerere plant supplies nearly half of the power dispatched to Tanzania's grid.

5 **Egypt is the leading clinker supplier to Côte d'Ivoire and Ghana.**

Egypt's cement and clinker exports rose from US$181.5m in 2020 to US$909.8m in 2024; it supplied 63% of Côte d'Ivoire's clinker imports. In 2025 finished cement rose 42% to US$493m and became the main export line, and rebar sales to Africa reached US$171m, four times the 2023 level.

6 **The carbon border could push Mediterranean supply south.**

Five Mediterranean origins supplied 74.6% of EU cement and clinker imports in 2025. At a constant 2026 certificate price, a plant at the EU benchmark pays about €1.25 a tonne of clinker in 2026 and about €24 in 2030; Exhibit 20 tests how much could move south.

WHAT IT MEANS

**Governments** should separate the choice of financier from the choice of builder wherever they can, and compare tied packages with open tenders.

**Developers** should test who actually builds behind the prime contractor, and secure cement and steel from more than one origin.

**Lenders** should treat contractor-arranged finance and guarantee lines as a growth market for the decade.

**Producers** should measure plant-level emissions now; the charge rises every year to 2034.

60

projects in the Heirstone Africa Builders Ledger, in 24 countries

5

Egyptian firms on ENR's 2024 Top 250 International Contractors, as many as France or India

8 of 8

tied-credit projects in the Ledger built by a firm from the lender's country

CHAPTER 1



# 01

# When the lender picks the builder

In Africa, who pays for a large project has often decided who builds it. That link is loosening as tied lending falls.

International contracting in Africa is a large business that is growing slowly. ENR's Top 250 International Contractors earned US$48.27bn on the continent in 2020, 11.48% of everything they earned outside their home markets. In 2024 the list earned US$502.1bn abroad, of which Africa took 10.5%, about US$52.7bn on our calculation. That is a nominal rise of about 9% in four years, and Africa now ranks behind Europe, Asia and the Middle East in the list's revenue.

Chinese contractors hold most of it. Their share of the Top 250's African revenue rose from around 10% in 2002 to about half by 2014, reached 61.9% in 2019 and stood at 61.6% in 2024, about US$32.5bn. Five of ENR's ten largest contractors in Africa in its 2025 ranking were Chinese groups: CCCC, CRCC, China Railway Group, PowerChina and CSCEC. In 2020 Italian firms were second, with 7.9%, and French firms third, with 6.7%.

The steadiness of that share hides a large change in how the work is paid for, set out on the next two pages.

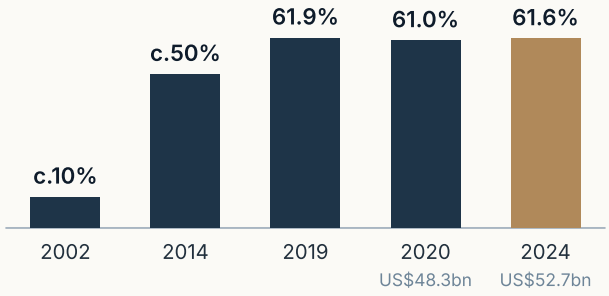
WHO PAYS

# Chinese state lending to Africa has fallen by more than nine-tenths; Chinese contracting revenue by less than a third

EXHIBIT 1

## China's share of international contractors' African revenue rose six-fold to 2019, then stopped rising

Chinese firms' share of ENR Top 250 International Contractors' revenue in Africa, by revenue year; Top 250 African revenue below the year where reported

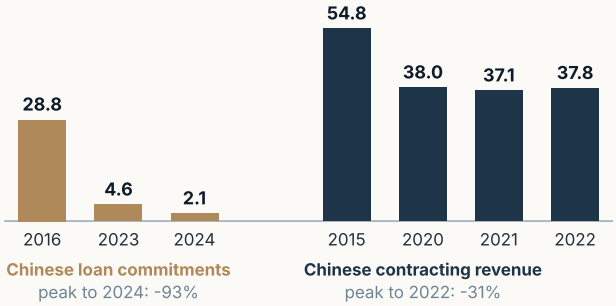



**Source:** ENR Top 250 International Contractors as reported by SAIS-CARI Working Paper 47 (2021), Qianzhan Industry Research (2022) and CHINCA via The Paper (2025). 2024 Africa total is **Heirstone analysis**: 10.5% of US$502.1bn.

EXHIBIT 2

## Loans fell by 93% from their peak; contracting revenue by 31%

Chinese loan commitments to Africa and Chinese construction revenue in Africa, US$bn, selected years




**Source:** Boston University GDP Center, Chinese Loans to Africa Database (2024, 2026); SAIS-CARI via South China Morning Post (2024) and Construction Briefing (2023); China-Africa Economic and Trade Relationship Report via China Daily (2023). Changes are **Heirstone analysis**.

Boston University's Chinese Loans to Africa Database counts US$180.87bn of commitments across 1,319 loans from 2000 to 2024. Lending peaked at about US$28.82bn in 2016, then fell to 13 loans worth US$4.61bn in 2023 and six projects worth just under US$2.1bn in 2024, about 93% below the peak. The remaining loans are smaller and increasingly in renminbi: all of Kenya's Chinese infrastructure loans in 2024 were in the Chinese currency.

Contracting revenue fell much less. SAIS-CARI data put Chinese construction revenue in Africa at US$54.78bn in 2015 and US$37.84bn in 2022, 31% lower, and official Chinese data show US$73.22bn of new African contracts signed in 2022. Even at the height of lending, Chinese loans covered less than 30% of Chinese firms' African turnover in most years from 2002 to 2018.

African budgets, development banks and other lenders pay for much of the rest. Chinese companies won 27.9% of the value of AfDB-awarded contracts in 2013 to 2018, four times the French total. In our Ledger, Tanzania paid for the Kigongo-Busisi bridge from domestic funds, the Namibian government and the AfDB funded Walvis Bay's container terminal, and the builder financed the Nairobi Expressway as a PPP. Chinese builders now compete for African and multilateral money as well as Chinese, while Africa's share of their global revenue fell from 38.9% in 2010 to 24.6% in 2020.

**83%**

of Chinese loan commitments to Africa from 2000 to 2023 came from China Exim and China Development Bank (83.13%)

**27.9%**

of the value of AfDB-awarded contracts went to Chinese firms in 2013 to 2018, US$4.4bn

**+13.8%**

growth of Chinese contractors' new contracts in Asia in 2024, to US$148.4bn, while new African contracts fell by double digits (CHINCA)

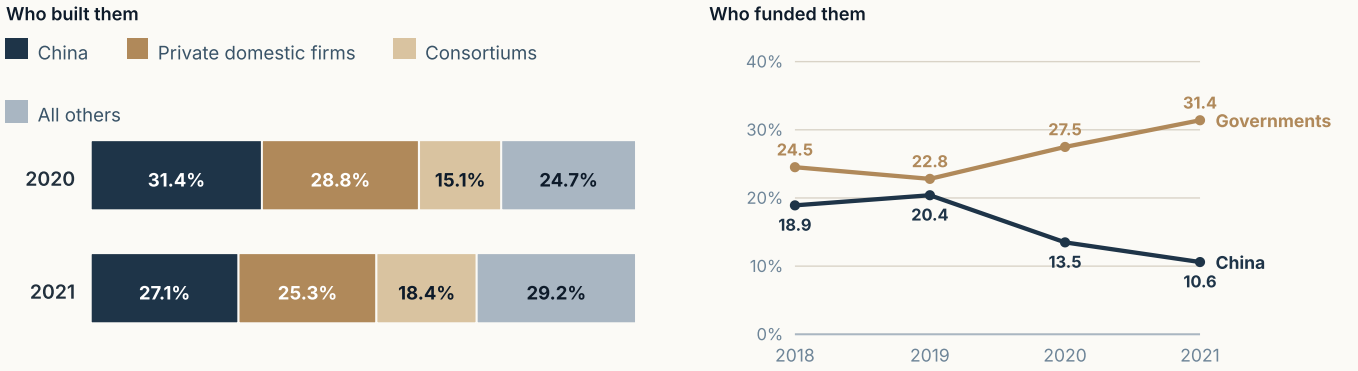
WHO BUILDS

# In Deloitte's latest count, local firms and consortiums built more of Africa's large projects than Chinese firms

EXHIBIT 3

## China's share of large projects built has fallen, and in 2021 African governments funded three times as many as China

Left: share of tracked projects by builder, Deloitte editions of 2020 and 2021. Right: share of tracked projects by funder, 2018 to 2021 editions. Projects of US$50m or more that had broken ground




**Source:** Deloitte, Africa Construction Trends 2018 to 2021 editions (the 2021 edition is the tenth and latest we could find). Others include EU, Middle Eastern, US and other builders; Deloitte did not report consortiums separately in its 2019 edition.

ENR measures what the world's largest international firms earn. Deloitte's Africa Construction Trends counts large projects whoever builds them, and its picture is different. The 2021 edition tracked 462 projects of US$50m or more worth US$521bn. Chinese firms built 27.1% of them, down from 31.4% a year earlier and 31% in 2019. Private domestic firms built 25.3% and consortiums 18.4%: together, local firms and joint ventures built 43.7% of Africa's large projects.

The funding has moved the same way. African governments funded 24.5% of tracked projects in 2018 and 31.4% in 2021. China's share peaked at 20.4% in 2019 and fell to 10.6% two years later. By value, governments funded 34.5% (US$137.7bn) in 2020 and China 14.8% (US$59.2bn).

Region matters. In East Africa Chinese firms built half of the 2021 projects, and in Central Africa 40%, with EU firms at 26.7%. In North Africa private domestic firms built 31.4% and consortiums 26.7%. In West Africa domestic firms built 28.1% against China's 22.9%, and in Southern Africa 32.1% against 24.5%.

Counting projects also understates buildings. Real estate was 18.4% of tracked projects in 2021 but 44.7% of their value, US$232.7bn, while transport was 42.6% of projects and 23.3% of value. Egypt had the highest value of tracked projects in Africa, US$108.8bn across 42 projects, ahead of Nigeria at US$100.9bn and South Africa at US$54.7bn.

**43.7%**

of large projects tracked in 2021 were built by private domestic firms and consortiums

**31.4%**

of tracked projects were funded by African governments in 2021; China funded 10.6%

**US$108.8bn**

value of Egypt's tracked projects in 2021, the highest in Africa

CHAPTER 2

# 02

# The Heirstone Africa Builders Ledger

Revenue rankings show who earns the money. To see how each contract was won, we built a project-level record of 60 projects in 24 countries: 39 landmark works since about 2015 in rail, roads, bridges, ports, power, airports and public buildings, and 21 projects of Egyptian contractors elsewhere in Africa.

For each we record the published value, the prime contractor and its nationality, the financier, the year and the route by which the contract was won. The Ledger is a purposive sample, and shares drawn from it describe its projects only. Where a value or a financier is not published, we say so and do not estimate it.

EXHIBIT 4

## Chinese builders lead the rail and port works by value; Turkish firms cluster in Tanzania, Senegal and Rwanda; Egyptian firms work in 16 countries beyond Egypt

Ledger projects by nationality of the prime contractor; circle area scales with published value




**Source:** Heirstone Africa Builders Ledger 2026 (pages 8 and 9). Points are GeoNames locations of the project or, for lines, a terminus or main town; the Equatorial Guinea programme is shown at Malabo. Djamaa el Djazaïr and Hassi Bir Rekaiz are not mapped. Numbers in brackets are projects per cluster.

BUILDER NATIONALITY

| | Projects | Value |
|---|---|---|
| China | 18 | 47.7% |
| Türkiye | 12 | 20.8% |
| Europe | 4 | 20.8% |
| Egypt | 24 | 10.2% |
| Other | 2 | 0.6% |

Value: share of the published US$ value of the 39 landmark projects (30 with values, US$46.2bn). **Heirstone analysis.**

**57%**

of the landmark projects' published value is rail, US$26.2bn across 13 lines and sections

**21**

of the 60 projects have a published financier; we classify the rest as not published

THE LEDGER

# Part one: rail, roads, bridges and ports

Values as published, in US$ million; local-currency and euro values converted at the annual average rate for the year shown (World Bank, Eurostat). SGR: standard gauge railway. n/p: not published. s: contract signed in that year; otherwise opened, completed or reported. Route: how the contract was won on the evidence (Chapter 3).

EXHIBIT 5

## The Heirstone Africa Builders Ledger 2026

| NO. | PROJECT | COUNTRY | US$M | PRIME CONTRACTOR | BUILDER | FINANCING | YEAR | ROUTE |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **RAIL** | | | | | | | | |
| L01 | Mombasa-Nairobi SGR | Kenya | 3,800 | CRBC | China | China Exim, about 90% | 2017 | Finance |
| L02 | Ethiopia-Djibouti rail, Mieso-Dewele (339 km) | Ethiopia | 1,120 | CCECC | China | n/p | 2011 s | Unclassified |
| L03 | Abuja-Kaduna railway (186 km) | Nigeria | 874 | CCECC | China | China Exim, federal funds | 2016 | Finance |
| L04 | Lagos-Ibadan railway | Nigeria | 1,530 | CCECC | China | n/p | 2012 s | Presence |
| L05 | SGR stage 1, Dar es Salaam-Morogoro (202 km) | Tanzania | 1,200 (loan) | Yapı Merkezi, Mota-Engil | Türkiye | Turkish export credit | 2024 | Finance |
| L06 | SGR stage 2, Morogoro-Makutupora | Tanzania | 1,900 | Yapı Merkezi | Türkiye | Commercial bank loan | 2024 | Presence |
| L07 | SGR stage 3, Makutupora-Tabora (368 km) | Tanzania | 1,900 | Yapı Merkezi | Türkiye | n/p | 2021 s | Presence |
| L08 | SGR stage 4, Tabora-Isaka (165 km) | Tanzania | 900 | Yapı Merkezi | Türkiye | n/p | 2022 s | Presence |
| L09 | SGR stage 5, Isaka-Mwanza (248 km) | Tanzania | 1,320 | CCECC, CRCC | China | Chinese loans (reported) | 2021 s | Finance |
| L10 | SGR Tabora-Kigoma (506 km) | Tanzania | 2,200 | CCECC, CRCC | China | n/p | 2022 s | Presence |
| L11 | Malaba-Kampala SGR (273 km) | Uganda | 3,000 | Yapı Merkezi | Türkiye | n/p | 2024 s | Unclassified |
| L12 | Awash-Kombolcha-Hara Gebeya railway (390 km) | Ethiopia | n/p | Yapı Merkezi | Türkiye | n/p | ongoing | Unclassified |
| L13 | High-speed rail, Ain Sokhna-Matrouh (660 km) | Egypt | 4,500 | Siemens Mobility (lead) | Germany | n/p | 2021 s | Partnership |
| L14 | Abidjan Metro Line 1 (37 km) | Côte d'Ivoire | 1,914 (€1.77bn) | Bouygues-led consortium | France | French government loan | 2023 s | Finance |
| **ROADS, BRIDGES AND PORTS** | | | | | | | | |
| L15 | Nairobi Expressway (27 km) | Kenya | 648 | CRBC | China | PPP, builder-financed | 2022 | Finance |
| L16 | Kigongo-Busisi bridge | Tanzania | 276 (TSh718bn) | CCECC, China Railway 15 Bureau | China | Domestic funds | 2025 | Price |
| L17 | Kazungula road-rail bridge | Zambia, Botswana | 259 | Daewoo E&C | S. Korea | AfDB and JICA | 2021 | Price |
| L18 | Maputo-Katembe bridge | Mozambique | 700+ | CRBC | China | n/p | 2018 | Unclassified |
| L19 | Lekki Deep Sea Port | Nigeria | 1,500+ | CHEC (52.5% shareholder) | China | Equity, CHEC 52.5% | 2023 | Finance |
| L20 | Walvis Bay container terminal | Namibia | 291 (R4.2bn) | CHEC | China | Namibia and AfDB | 2019 | Price |

**Source:** Heirstone Africa Builders Ledger 2026. Main sources: Railway Gazette International (2022), RailwayPRO (2022, 2023), Railway Technology, Yapı Merkezi, Ahram Online (2026), International Railway Journal (2023), Africanews (2022), Daily News Tanzania (2025), Construction Review Online (2021), Club of Mozambique, Maritimafrica (2023), The Citizen (2019), Horn Affairs (2011). Tabora-Isaka: US$900.1m (Railway Gazette, TanzaniaInvest) or US$2bn (RailwayPRO); lower figure used. Conversions are **Heirstone analysis**.

### Rail carries the value

Thirteen rail lines and sections with published values account for US$26.2bn, 57% of the published value of the landmark projects. Tanzania's standard gauge railway alone has six entries, Turkish and Chinese.

### Hydropower is mixed

Chinese, Italian, Brazilian and Egyptian primes all built or are building Africa's large dams (part two). The largest by value is Caculo Cabaça in Angola at US$4.5bn; the most recently completed is Julius Nyerere in Tanzania, under an Egyptian prime contract.

### Repeat clients recur

Builders return to the same clients: Yapı Merkezi on four Tanzanian sections, CCECC on three Nigerian contracts, CSCEC twice in Algeria and the Arab Contractors across Uganda. Presence explains 13 of the 60 awards.

### Disclosure is thin

21 of the 60 projects have a published financier, and 36 a published value we can express in US dollars. Buyers and lenders should expect to ask for both.

THE LEDGER, CONTINUED

# Part two: power, buildings and Egyptian firms

Exhibit 5, continued. Conventions as in part one.

| NO. | PROJECT | COUNTRY | US$M | PRIME CONTRACTOR | BUILDER | FINANCING | YEAR | ROUTE |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **POWER** | | | | | | | | |
| L21 | Julius Nyerere Hydropower Project (2,115 MW) | Tanzania | 2,900 | Arab Contractors, Elsewedy | Egypt | Government of Tanzania | 2026 | Partnership |
| L22 | Karuma hydropower (600 MW) | Uganda | 1,700 | Sinohydro | China | n/p | 2024 | Unclassified |
| L23 | Caculo Cabaça hydropower (2,170 MW) | Angola | 4,500 | China Gezhouba | China | n/p | 2017 | Unclassified |
| L24 | Laúca hydropower (2,070 MW) | Angola | n/p | Odebrecht | Brazil | n/p | 2017 | Unclassified |
| L25 | Koysha hydropower (2,200 MW) | Ethiopia | 2,767 (€2.5bn) | Webuild | Italy | Italy's SACE | 2016 s | Finance |
| L26 | Cap des Biches gas plant (300 MW) | Senegal | 410 | Çalık Enerji with GE | Türkiye | n/p | 2020 s | Partnership |
| **BUILDINGS, VENUES AND AIRPORTS** | | | | | | | | |
| L27 | Iconic Tower, New Administrative Capital | Egypt | n/p | CSCEC | China | n/p | 2024 | Unclassified |
| L28 | Djamaa el Djazaïr, Algiers | Algeria | 898 to 2,000 | CSCEC | China | n/p | 2019 | Presence |
| L29 | Grand Egyptian Museum | Egypt | 1,800 | Orascom, BESIX | Egypt | n/p | 2025 | Partnership |
| L30 | Borg El Arab airport, new terminal | Egypt | n/p | Orascom, BESIX, Taisei | Egypt | n/p | 2024 | Partnership |
| L31 | Algiers airport, new terminal | Algeria | 617 (€551m) | CSCEC | China | n/p | 2019 | Presence |
| L32 | Dakar airport (AIBD) | Senegal | €566m (2011 est.) | Summa, Limak | Türkiye | BOT, 25-year operation | 2017 | Finance |
| L33 | National stadium, Diamniadio (50,000 seats) | Senegal | n/p | Summa | Türkiye | n/p | 2022 | Speed |
| L34 | Dakar Arena (15,000 seats) | Senegal | n/p | Summa | Türkiye | n/p | 2018 | Speed |
| L35 | Kigali Convention Centre | Rwanda | 300 | Summa | Türkiye | n/p | 2016 | Unclassified |
| L36 | Kigali Arena | Rwanda | n/p | Summa | Türkiye | n/p | 2019 | Speed |
| L37 | Lusaka airport upgrade | Zambia | 360 | China Jiangxi Corporation | China | China Exim | 2021 | Finance |
| L38 | Abuja airport terminal (one of four) | Nigeria | 600 (four) | CCECC | China | China Exim, federal funds | 2018 | Finance |
| L39 | Bugesera airport, phase I | Rwanda | 418 | Mota-Engil | Portugal | Concession | 2016 s | Finance |
| **EGYPTIAN CONTRACTORS ELSEWHERE IN AFRICA** | | | | | | | | |
| E01 | Iganga-Bulopa-Kamuli road (56 km) | Uganda | 70 | Arab Contractors | Egypt | n/p | 2024 s | Presence |
| E02 | Pallisa and Kumi town roads | Uganda | 34 | Arab Contractors | Egypt | n/p | 2024 | Presence |
| E03 | Saaka road and Mpologoma bridge | Uganda | n/p | Arab Contractors | Egypt | n/p | 2024 | Speed |
| E04 | Mutanda-Mwinilunga road (85 km) | Zambia | n/p | Arab Contractors | Egypt | n/p | 2026 s | Unclassified |
| E05 | Six wastewater treatment plants | Côte d'Ivoire | n/p | Arab Contractors | Egypt | n/p | 2024 s | Unclassified |
| E06 | Housing, roads and utilities programme | Equatorial Guinea | €1.5bn since 2003 | Arab Contractors | Egypt | n/p | 2003-25 | Presence |
| E07 | Soyo-Cabinda land and maritime road | Angola | n/p | Arab Contractors | Egypt | n/p | 2026 s | Unclassified |
| E08 | Derna reconstruction: bridges and road | Libya | n/p | Arab Contractors | Egypt | n/p | 2024 s | Presence |
| E09 | Bangoma port expansion, Mohéli | Comoros | n/p | Arab Contractors | Egypt | n/p | 2024 | Unclassified |
| E10 | Emergency thermal plants (150 MW) | Angola | 484 | Elsewedy Electric | Egypt | EPC+F | 2018 | Finance |
| E11 | Malanje-Xa-Mutabe 400 kV line (192 km) | Angola | 421 (€373m) | Elsewedy Electric | Egypt | EPC+F | n/p | Finance |
| E12 | Maputo coastal protection | Mozambique | 48 | Elsewedy Electric | Egypt | n/p | n/p | Unclassified |
| E13 | Koumassi flyover, Abidjan (700 m) | Côte d'Ivoire | n/p | Elsewedy Electric | Egypt | MCA grant | 2023 | Price |
| E14 | Yeleen solar plant (42 MWp) | Burkina Faso | n/p | Elsewedy Electric | Egypt | n/p | 2021 | Presence |
| E15 | Matourkou solar plant and storage | Burkina Faso | n/p | Elsewedy Electric | Egypt | n/p | 2025 | Presence |
| E16 | Bo and Port Loko solar (20 MW) | Sierra Leone | n/p | Elsewedy Electric | Egypt | n/p | 2021 | Unclassified |
| E17 | Kasumbalesa 220 kV substation | DR Congo | n/p | Elsewedy Electric | Egypt | n/p | 2021 | Unclassified |
| E18 | 400 kV lines, Agadir region | Morocco | n/p | Elsewedy Electric | Egypt | n/p | 2021 | Unclassified |
| E19 | Sfax seawater desalination plant | Tunisia | n/p | Orascom (consortium) | Egypt | n/p | 2026 | Partnership |
| E20 | Jiji and Mulembwe hydropower (51 MW) | Burundi | n/p | Orascom, CMC di Ravenna | Egypt | n/p | 2025-26 | Partnership |
| E21 | Hassi Bir Rekaiz oil field, phase 2 | Algeria | 1,087 | Petrojet (lead), Arkad | Egypt | Client funds | 2025 s | Partnership |

**Source:** Heirstone Africa Builders Ledger 2026. Main sources: Egypt Today and Xinhua (2026); The Independent Uganda (2024); Renewable Energy World (2017); ENR and Sudan Tribune (2016) for Koysha; Enerdata (2021); CTBUH; Chatham House (2020); Orascom Construction; Al Gomhuria (2025); Voyages d'Affaires (2019); AIBD; Summa; KT Press (2016); Zambia Airports Corporation (2020); Vanguard (2018); Al Jazeera (2019); The Arab Contractors (2024 to 2026); Elsewedy Electric; MEED (2025). Djamaa el Djazaïr: Chatham House gives nearly US$2bn; official figures cited elsewhere are about US$898m. Malanje line converted at the 2025 average. **Heirstone analysis.**

FINANCE AND PRICE

# In every Ledger project paid for by a tied lender, the builder came from the lender's country

EXHIBIT 6

## In the Ledger, tied credit went to the lender's own builders eight times out of eight; open money went to builders of four nationalities

Ledger projects by type of finance and nationality of the prime contractor; number of projects, and published value in US$ million

| HOW THE PROJECT WAS FINANCED | CHINA | TÜRKIYE | EGYPT | EUROPE | OTHER | PROJECTS | US$M PUBLISHED | BUILDER FROM THE FINANCIER'S COUNTRY |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Tied credit from the builder's home country** | **5** | **1** | - | **2** | - | **8** | 12,835 | 8 of 8 |
| **Arranged by the contractor: EPC+F, PPP, equity or concession** | **2** | **1** | **2** | **1** | - | **6** | 3,471 | 6 of 6 (builder finances) |
| **Development banks and donors** | **1** | - | **1** | - | **1** | **3** | 550 | open tender |
| **African budget, commercial loan or client funds** | **1** | **1** | **2** | - | - | **4** | 6,163 | open tender |
| **Financing not published** | **9** | **9** | **19** | **1** | **1** | **39** | 25,329 | |

**Source:** Heirstone Africa Builders Ledger 2026. Tied credit: China Exim and other Chinese lenders (five projects), Turkish export credit, the French government and Italy's SACE (ENR, 2016). Open money: AfDB, JICA, the Millennium Challenge Account, African budgets, a commercial bank loan and an oil company client. **Heirstone analysis.**

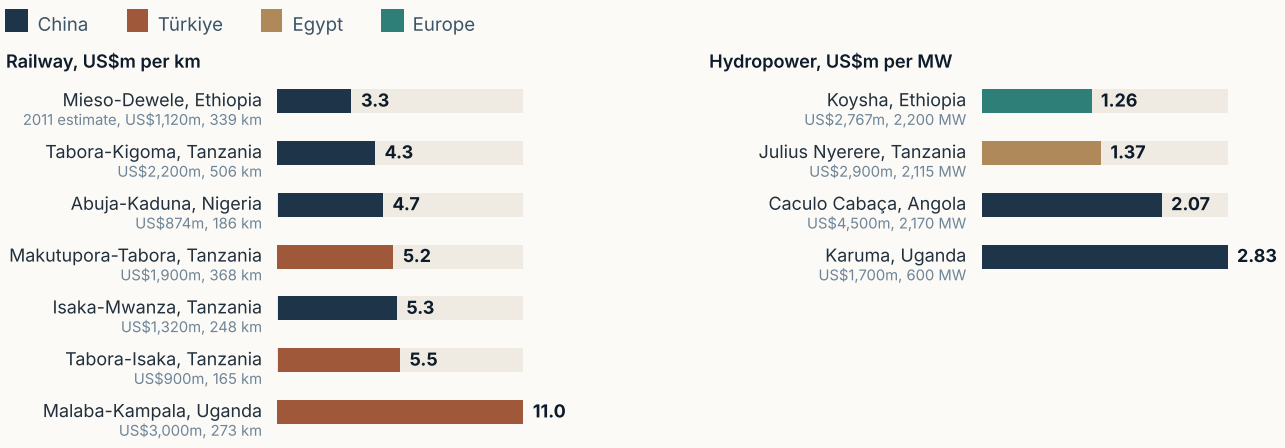
The Ledger lets us test a claim often made and rarely measured: that the financier chooses the builder. Financing is published for 21 of the 60 projects. Eight were paid for by a lender tied to one country: Chinese lenders on five, and Turkish export credit, the French government and Italy's SACE on one each. In all eight the prime contractor came from the lender's country. On six more the contractor brought the money itself, through EPC+F, a PPP, an equity stake or a concession.

The other seven were paid for with money that does not travel with a builder: the AfDB and JICA, the Millennium Challenge Account, African budgets, a commercial bank loan and an oil company paying from its own funds. They went to builders of four nationalities: three Egyptian, two Chinese, one Turkish and one Korean. The sample is small, so we do not turn it into a market share. Its direction is consistent with the fall in Chinese lending: as tied money shrinks, more of Africa's large contracts become open to other builders.

EXHIBIT 7

## Most standard-gauge contracts cost US$4m to US$6m a kilometre; hydropower ranges from US$1.3m to US$2.8m a megawatt

Contract value as published divided by length or installed capacity, US$m per km and US$m per MW




**Source:** Heirstone Africa Builders Ledger 2026; contract values and lengths as in Exhibit 5. Tabora-Isaka at US$900.1m (RailwayPRO gives US$2bn); some lengths include sidings, and Isaka-Mwanza is also reported at 341 km, which would give US$3.9m. Koysha converted from €2.5bn at the 2016 average of US$1.107 per euro. Scopes differ (stations, electrification, terrain, civil works and equipment) and dates range from 2011 to 2024, so values are not like-for-like prices. **Heirstone analysis.**

CHAPTER 3

# 03 Five routes to a contract

Builders win African contracts in five ways. Each nationality in the Ledger leans on a different mix, and each route asks the buyer a different question.

We assigned every Ledger project to one route, using published facts only. Where the financier is the builder's home lender or the builder itself, the route is finance. Otherwise we look, in order, for a published fast-track date, a consortium or joint venture and repeat work for the same client or network; open tenders paid for by budgets or development banks fall to price. Where none of this is published, the project is unclassified.

EXHIBIT 8

## The Heirstone Five Routes: finance and presence explain most awards in the Ledger, and each nationality leans on a different mix

Ledger projects by route to the contract and by nationality of the prime contractor; number of projects

China · Türkiye · Egypt · Europe · Other

| ROUTE | HOW THE CONTRACT IS WON | LEDGER PROJECTS | BY BUILDER NATIONALITY | LEDGER EXAMPLES | WHAT THE BUYER SHOULD TEST |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 Finance | The builder brings the money: home-country export credit, or EPC+F, a PPP, equity or a concession. | 14 | China 7, Europe 3, Türkiye 2, Egypt 2 | Mombasa-Nairobi SGR (China Exim); Abidjan metro (French government); Nairobi Expressway (PPP); Angola power plants (EPC+F) | Compare the whole package, finance included, with an open tender. |
| 2 Presence | Repeat work for the same client, network or country, with people and plant already there. | 13 | Egypt 6, China 4, Türkiye 3 | Yapı Merkezi on Tanzania SGR stages 2 to 4; Arab Contractors in Equatorial Guinea and Uganda; CSCEC in Algeria | Ask for the record with this client and what the plant on site saves. |
| 3 Partnership | A consortium or joint venture joins a lead contractor to specialist partners and suppliers. | 8 | Egypt 6, Türkiye 1, Europe 1 | Julius Nyerere (Arab Contractors, Elsewedy); Grand Egyptian Museum (Orascom, BESIX); Jiji and Mulembwe (Orascom, CMC) | Find out who carries the risk, who builds each part and whose equipment goes in. |
| 4 Speed | A fixed date, an event or a completion record decides the award. | 4 | Türkiye 3, Egypt 1 | Senegal stadium in 17 months and Kigali Arena in 168 days (Summa); Saaka road 11 months early (Arab Contractors) | Price the date, and what the builder stakes on it. |
| 5 Price | An open tender paid for by a budget, a development bank or a donor. | 4 | China 2, Egypt 1, Other 1 | Kazungula bridge (AfDB, JICA); Walvis Bay terminal (AfDB); Kigongo-Busisi bridge (domestic funds); Koumassi flyover (MCA) | Benchmark the unit price (Exhibit 7) and the bidder's bonding capacity. |
| Unclassified | Award basis and financing not published. | 17 | Egypt 8, China 5, Türkiye 3, Other 1 | | |

**Source:** Heirstone Africa Builders Ledger 2026; company and press sources as in Exhibit 5. Classification is **Heirstone analysis**; each project is counted once, under the first route that applies.

The mix differs by nationality. Chinese builders won 7 of their 18 Ledger projects through finance and 4 through presence, mostly repeat railway and airport work. European primes won 3 of 4 on finance: two with their own governments' or export agencies' money and one through a concession. Turkish firms won through speed and presence: three venues built against a date and three Tanzanian railway sections.

Egyptian firms won most often through partnership (6 projects) and presence (6), and on open money they won three of the seven Ledger projects. The routes overlap: Elsewedy's Angolan plants were financed by the contractor and connected to the grid in ten months, and Summa's Dakar airport combined a concession with a deadline. The buyer's task is to know which route is being sold, and to price it.

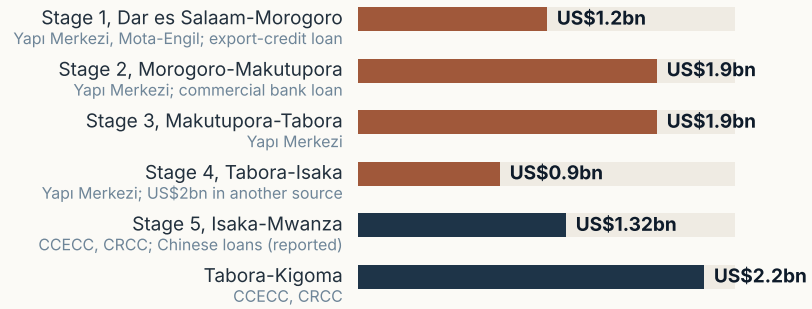
TÜRKIYE, EUROPE AND THE LAYERS BENEATH

# Turkish builders win where a date matters, and on the Tanzanian railway sections in our Ledger they hold more signed value than Chinese firms

EXHIBIT 9

## On the Ledger's Tanzanian railway sections, Turkish-led contracts total about US$5.9bn against US$3.5bn for Chinese builders

Signed contract value by section and builder, US$bn; stage 1 shown at its loan value




**Source:** Railway Gazette International (2022); RailwayPRO (2022, 2023); TanzaniaInvest (2022, 2025); Yapı Merkezi. Stage 4: Railway Gazette and TanzaniaInvest give US$900.1m, RailwayPRO US$2bn; we use the lower figure. Excludes the US$2.15bn Uvinza-Musongati line to Burundi, signed with Chinese firms in 2025. Totals are **Heirstone analysis**.

Turkish contractors are a large international group with a selective African business. From 1972 to the end of 2025 they undertook 12,827 projects worth US$557.5bn in 138 countries, according to the Turkish Contractors Association. Africa took 17.7% of that volume, about US$98.7bn on our calculation, much of it in Libya, which took 65.7% of Turkish overseas volume in the 1970s and 56.6% in the 1980s. No African country was among their five largest markets in 2020 to 2024. On ENR's 2025 list, 45 Turkish firms earned US$20.8bn abroad, second only to China by number of firms.

In Africa they win where a date matters. Summa built Senegal's 50,000-seat national stadium in 17 months and Kigali Arena in 168 days, and with Limak completed Dakar's airport, which the two operate under a 25-year concession. Summa says 99% of its work is in Africa; in 2024 the IFC disclosed a loan of up to €50m (US$56.81m) to it, partly for working capital on African projects.

Rail is the other Turkish strength. Yapı Merkezi won Tanzania's first section with Mota-Engil Africa on a US$1.2bn Turkish export credit, then stages 2 to 4 on other money, and in 2024 signed the 273 km Malaba-Kampala line in Uganda for about US$3bn. Its East African contracts since stage 1 come to about US$7.7bn on our count.

Two of the four European-led projects in the Ledger came with their own governments' finance: a Bouygues-led consortium on Abidjan's €1.77bn metro with a €250m French government loan, and Webuild on Ethiopia's €2.5bn Koysha dam with financing from Italy's SACE, according to ENR. Korea's Daewoo built the Kazungula bridge on AfDB and JICA money.

**US$7.7bn**

Yapı Merkezi's East African rail contracts: Tanzania stages 2 to 4 and Malaba-Kampala

**17.7%**

Africa's share of Turkish contractors' cumulative overseas work, 1972 to 2025

**168 days**

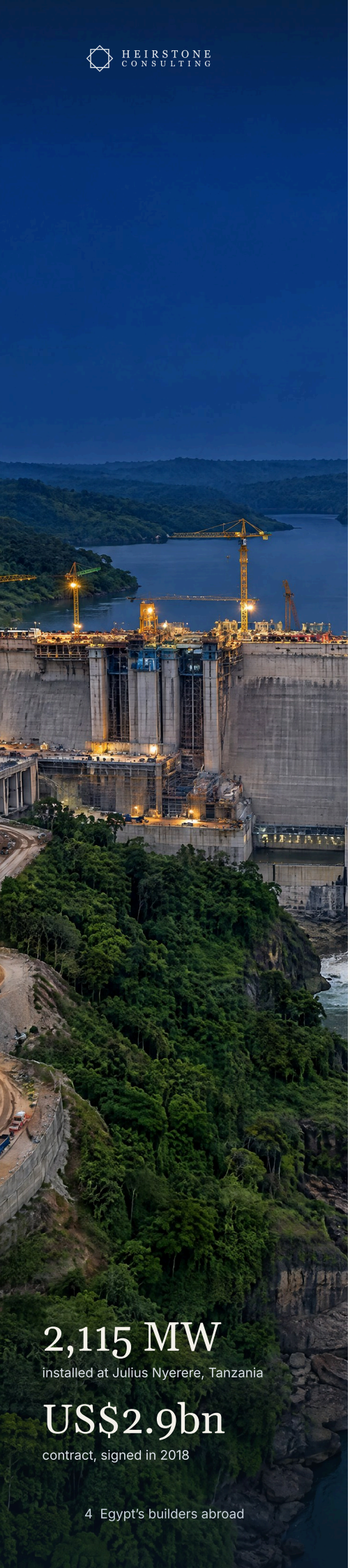
to build Kigali Arena (2019)

### NATIONALITY HAS LAYERS

Julius Nyerere is an Egyptian prime contract on which PowerChina built the main works and Dongfang Electric supplied the nine units.

Tanzania's first railway section had a Turkish prime, a Portuguese partner and Turkish export credit; stage two used a Standard Chartered loan.

Lekki Deep Sea Port was built by CHEC, which also owns 52.5% of it alongside Tolaram, Lagos State and the Nigerian Ports Authority.



2,115 MW
installed at Julius Nyerere, Tanzania

US$2.9bn
contract, signed in 2018

4 Egypt's builders abroad

CHAPTER 4

# 04

# Egypt's builders abroad

## Egypt's leading contractors now win much of their business outside Egypt. Their flagship is a dam in Tanzania.

In 2018 Tanzania chose the Arab Contractors, teamed with Elsewedy Electric, to design and build the Julius Nyerere Hydropower Project on the Rufiji River under a US$2.9bn contract. It is a turnkey lump-sum EPC contract for a 2,115 MW plant with nine 235 MW Francis units, designed to generate about 6,307 GWh a year. The works include a dam crest of 1,025 m and a reservoir of about 34bn $m^3$, with about 4 million $m^3$ of excavation, about 3 million $m^3$ of concrete, 1.4 million $m^3$ of it roller-compacted in the main dam, and about 64,000 tonnes of reinforcing steel.

Impounding began in 2022, the first turbine turned in 2024 and the plant was inaugurated in 2026. It now supplies nearly half of the electricity dispatched to Tanzania's national grid, according to Xinhua. The Egyptian joint venture held the prime contract and ran a supply chain that included PowerChina on the main works and Dongfang Electric for the generating units. At about US$1.37m per megawatt, its contract value is among the lower ones in our Ledger.

> *About 3 million cubic metres of concrete and 64,000 tonnes of steel went into Julius Nyerere, under an Egyptian prime contract.*

The dam is the most visible part of a wider shift. Egypt had five firms on ENR's 2024 list of the Top 250 international contractors, as many as France or India. Orascom Construction rose to eighth among contractors in Africa in ENR's 2026 ranking, from tenth. On their published measures, Elsewedy holds 72% of its construction order book abroad and Petrojet signed 60% of its 2024 contracts there; a 2026 press report puts about half of Hassan Allam's projects outside Egypt.

**6,307 GWh**
design output a year

**34bn $m^3$**
reservoir behind a 1,025 m crest

**nearly half**
of power dispatched to Tanzania's grid (Xinhua, 2026)

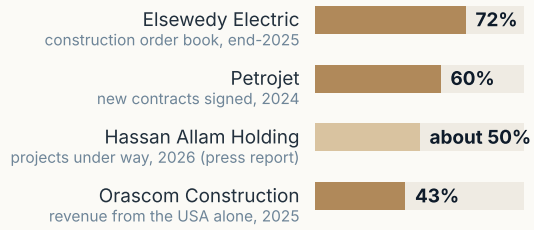
SCALE AND REACH

# On the measures they publish, Egypt's leading contractors book between 43% and 72% of their business outside Egypt

EXHIBIT 10

## Egypt's leading contractors are now exporters of construction services

Share of business outside Egypt, on each firm's published measure (Hassan Allam: press report), latest year




**Source:** Elsewedy Electric FY2025 results; Daily News Egypt (2025, Petrojet general assembly); Billionaires.Africa (2026); Orascom Construction FY2025 results. Bases differ by firm.

The firms report on different bases and their figures cannot be added. All point the same way. Elsewedy's engineering and construction order book reached EGP 293bn at the end of 2025, about US$6.16bn, with 72% outside Egypt; measured in dollars at each date's rate, the part abroad roughly doubled from about US$2.1bn in mid-2023 to US$4.4bn.

Orascom's revenue rose about 55% in 2025 to US$5.05bn on US$5.58bn of new awards, and its order book reached a record US$10.9bn at mid-2026, or US$14.5bn with its half of BESIX. Petrojet signed EGP 112bn of new contracts in 2024, 60% of them abroad.

EXHIBIT 11

## The four Egyptian groups that publish 2025 revenue earned about US$13.8bn between them; Petrojet reports contracts signed

Latest published figures; EGP converted at the World Bank annual average for flows (EGP 45.30 per US$ in 2024, 49.23 in 2025) and the US Treasury quarter-end rate for order books (EGP 47.6 at end-2025)

| FIRM | REVENUE | ORDER BOOK | BUSINESS ABROAD | PEOPLE | AFRICA OUTSIDE EGYPT |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Orascom Construction** | US$5.05bn (2025) | US$9.0bn; US$13.0bn with its 50% of BESIX | 43% of revenue from the USA; MEA awards led by Saudi Arabia and Egypt | 51,000+ incl. BESIX (2023) | Algeria, Tunisia, Burundi; ENR 8th in Africa (2026) |
| **Elsewedy Electric** | EGP 281.0bn, about US$5.71bn (2025) | E&C EGP 293bn, about US$6.16bn | 72% of E&C order book; 78% of cable sales | about 18,000 | Tanzania, Angola, Mozambique, Burkina Faso, Côte d'Ivoire |
| **Hassan Allam Holding** | US$2.1bn (2025) | above US$7.2bn | about half of projects under execution (press, 2026) | 50,000+ | Algeria, DR Congo; Gulf work in Saudi Arabia, UAE, Oman |
| **Arab Contractors** | EGP 48bn, about US$975m (2025) | n/p | offices in 19 African countries | about 57,000 | Uganda, Zambia, Equatorial Guinea, Angola, Libya, Côte d'Ivoire |
| **Petrojet** | new contracts EGP 112bn, about US$2.47bn (2024) | EGP 215bn of work expected to 2028 | 60% of 2024 contracts | 42,000 | Algeria (US$1.087bn field contract, 2025) |

**Source:** Orascom Construction FY2025 and H1 2026 results, Annual Report 2023 and ENR release (2026); Elsewedy Electric FY2025 results and website; Forbes Middle East (2026); Billionaires.Africa (2026); The Arab Contractors website; Daily News Egypt and Amwal Al Ghad (2025). Conversions and the US$13.8bn total (Orascom, Elsewedy, Hassan Allam, Arab Contractors) are **Heirstone analysis**. Elsewedy revenue includes manufacturing.

The group is broader than five names. In 2016 the Egyptian Federation for Construction and Building Contractors counted 22 Egyptian construction firms working in Africa besides the Arab Contractors. Redcon aims to earn half its revenue abroad within four to five years, and Concord has formed a joint company with the UAE's Bin Wanis to pursue tunnels, rail and roads in Egypt, the UAE and Africa.

The work abroad is weighted to power, water and roads. Orascom cites more than 30 GW of power projects completed or under construction across the Middle East and Africa and, with its partner, more than 17 million $m^3$ a day of water capacity; Elsewedy cites 23 GW delivered and 23,000 km of transmission and distribution lines.

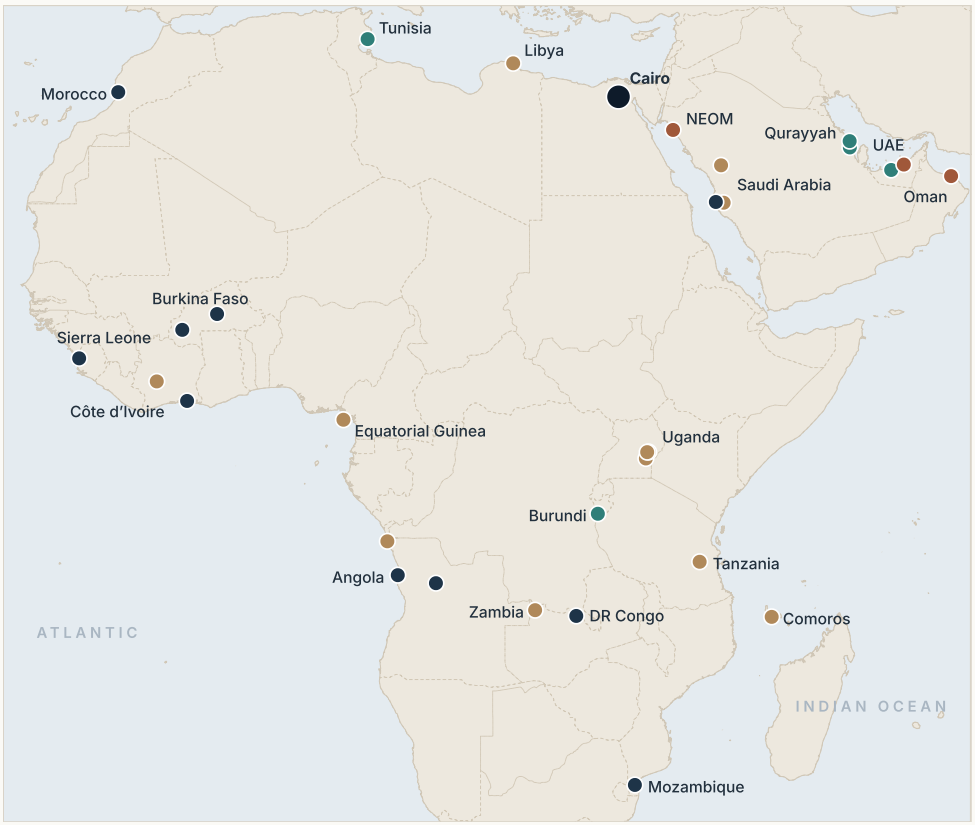
FOOTPRINT

# From Abidjan to Abu Dhabi: Egypt's contractors build across Africa and the Gulf, with a strong francophone presence

EXHIBIT 12

## Egyptian contractors' projects reach 16 African countries outside Egypt in the Ledger, and three Gulf states

Selected projects of four Egyptian contractors outside Egypt, by firm; Julius Nyerere shown under Arab Contractors (joint venture with Elsewedy)




PROJECTS MAPPED

- Arab Contractors (12)
- Elsewedy Electric (10)
- Orascom Construction (5)
- Hassan Allam (3)

**1964**

year the Arab Contractors entered Africa, through a branch in Libya

**€1.5bn**

Arab Contractors' cumulative work in Equatorial Guinea, 2003 to 2024

**+50%**

added to Burundi's generating capacity by Orascom's Jiji and Mulembwe plants

Source: Heirstone Africa Builders Ledger 2026; The Arab Contractors, Elsewedy Electric, Orascom Construction and Hassan Allam Holding project pages and releases (2023 to 2026). Points are GeoNames locations of the nearest named place; the Equatorial Guinea programme is shown at Malabo. Petrojet's Algerian and Saudi projects are not geocoded.

**Arab Contractors** has the widest African footprint. It entered Africa through a branch in Libya in 1964, counts 1,000 projects in 26 African countries and lists offices in 19. Its model is the long-tenure country franchise: about €1.5bn of work in Equatorial Guinea since 2003, including 1,000 homes and the 60 km Azok-Akassi road, with new housing assigned in 2025. In Uganda it delivered four roads totalling 160 km in five years, won a 56 km road for US$70m in 2024 and finished the Saaka road and bridge 11 months early, earning an ENR Award of Merit. Newer contracts include roads in Zambia and Angola and wastewater plants in Côte d'Ivoire.

**Elsewedy Electric** sells power systems with finance attached: three emergency plants of 150 MW in Angola for US$484m on an EPC+F basis, one connected to the grid in ten months, and a 192 km, 400 kV line worth €373m on the same basis. It has built two solar plants for Burkina Faso's utility. **Orascom Construction** works at the scale of national utilities: its Jiji and Mulembwe plants raise Burundi's generating capacity by more than half, and the Sfax desalination plant can serve up to one million people in Tunisia. In the Gulf, Orascom is building the 3 GW Qurayyah expansion, Hassan Allam the Port of NEOM container terminal, and Arab Contractors finished its Makkah ring road sections about 136 days early.

HOME BASE AND FINANCE

# A decade of building at home gave Egypt's contractors scale; guarantee lines and contractor finance help them carry it abroad

EXHIBIT 13

## Finance is part of the Egyptian offer

Credit lines, contractor-arranged finance and state programmes behind Egyptian contractors' work in Africa

| PROVIDER | INSTRUMENT | AMOUNT | FOR | YEAR |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Afreximbank** | Credit facilities to Egyptian companies for projects in Africa | US$3bn | Egyptian companies | 2023 |
| | Guarantees and working capital for African projects | US$300m | Elsewedy Electric | 2023 |
| | Letters of guarantee for continental projects | US$200m | Arab Contractors | 2023 |
| | Loans, discounting and guarantees for Africa and the Middle East | US$200m | Hassan Allam Holding | 2023 |
| **Contractor (EPC+F)** | Emergency power plants, 150 MW | US$484m | Angola, built by Elsewedy | 2018 |
| **Contractor (EPC+F)** | 400 kV line and two substations, 192 km | €373m | Angola, built by Elsewedy | n/p |
| **Government of Egypt** | Development projects in Southern Nile Basin countries | US$100m | Nile Basin countries | 2025 |
| **Egyptian Agency of Partnership for Development** | Training programmes for African officials | 230 programmes | 6,800+ participants | 2014 to 2018 |

**Source:** Business Today Egypt (2023), quoting Afreximbank; Elsewedy Electric project pages; Cairo Governorate (2025), citing Al-Ahram Online; Embassy of Egypt in Washington (2018). The Malanje line is worth about US$421m at the 2025 average euro rate (**Heirstone analysis**).

Egypt was Africa's largest market for large projects by value in Deloitte's 2021 count: 42 projects worth US$108.8bn. A decade of national programmes gave its contractors volume, plant and project-management depth. Ministry of Transport figures reported in the press count 945 bridges and tunnels built since 2014 and a national roads programme of 7,000 km of new roads; a separate review counts 4,000 km of new roads and EGP 200bn invested in the six years to mid-2024. Construction employed 3.7 million people directly in 2018, and on preliminary Ministry of Planning data it grew 4.1% in FY2024/25 and 5.6% in the third quarter of FY2025/26.

The home portfolio is a reference list in itself. Orascom and BESIX built the Grand Egyptian Museum, inaugurated in 2025 at a reported cost of about US$1.8bn; an Alstom and Arab Contractors joint venture is delivering Cairo's West Nile monorail, part of a network of about 100 km; and Orascom's operating wind capacity reached 913 MW in 2025.

Finance carries that capacity abroad, because African tenders require bid bonds, performance guarantees and working capital before the first payment. In 2023 Afreximbank extended US$3bn of facilities to Egyptian companies, including US$300m to Elsewedy and US$200m each to the Arab Contractors and Hassan Allam for guarantees and projects in Africa. Egypt's foreign minister put Egyptian investment in Africa above US$14bn in 2025.

**US$108.8bn**

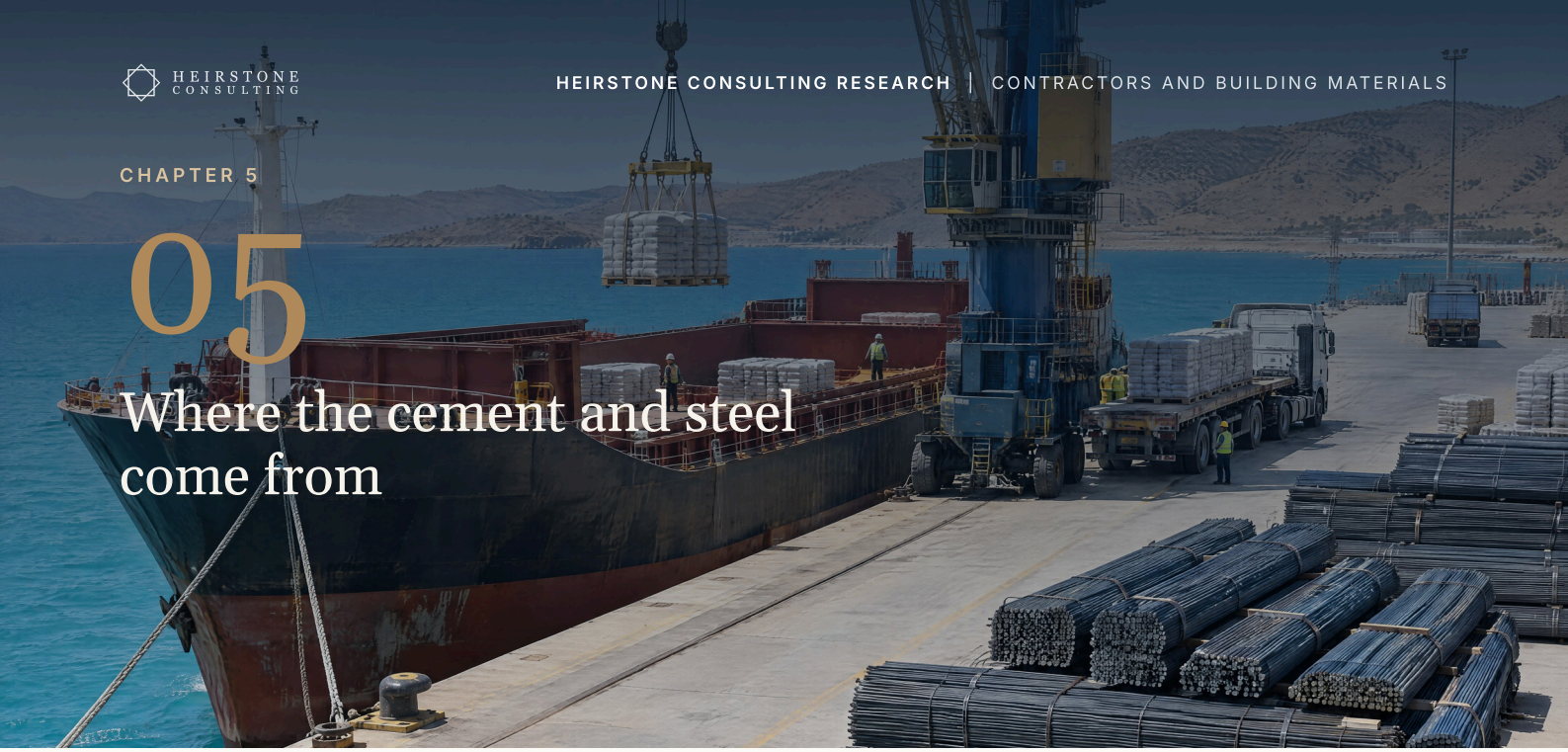
value of Egypt's tracked large projects, the highest in Africa (Deloitte, 2021)

**3.7m**

people employed directly in construction in Egypt (2018)

**US$3bn**

Afreximbank facilities to Egyptian companies in 2023, US$700m of it to three contractors



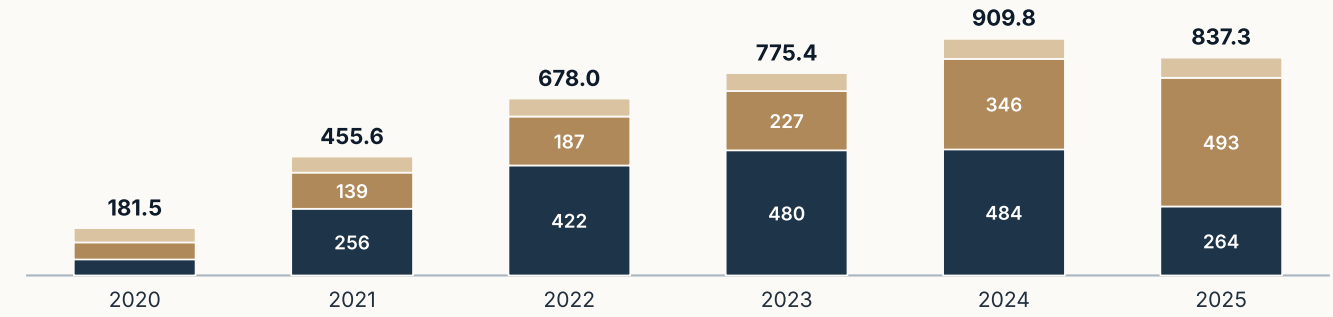
CHAPTER 5

# 05 Where the cement and steel come from

EXHIBIT 14

## Egypt's cement exports rose five-fold in four years, and in 2025 finished cement became the largest line

Egypt's exports of cement and clinker by product, US$ million, 2020 to 2025




**Source:** UN Comtrade data through World Bank WITS, Egypt's exports of HS 252310, 252321, 252329 and 252390, accessed 2026; 2025 total as published by Arab Finance (2026). Egypt's Comtrade quantities are estimated from a fixed unit value, so values are used.

Africa made about 211 Mt of cement in 2019, the latest year in which the US Geological Survey published every country in one table: 108.4 Mt in Sub-Saharan Africa and 102.4 Mt in North Africa, on our sum. Egypt was the largest producer at 48.7 Mt, ahead of Algeria (27.7 Mt) and Nigeria (22.6 Mt). It produced 54.98 Mt in FY2024/25, and the USGS estimates 64 Mt for 2025 on clinker capacity of 75 Mt.

Exports grew faster than output, reaching about 100 markets. African buyers took 77.7% of Egypt's clinker exports by value in 2024, led by Côte d'Ivoire (US$134.3m) and Ghana (US$105.7m), and 64.3% of its grey cement, led by Libya.

In 2025 the mix moved up the value chain. Plants ran at 98% of capacity as home demand rose to 54 Mt, and grey Portland cement exports rose 42% to US$493.0m, overtaking clinker as the main line. Titan Egypt has said it plans to stop exporting clinker and concentrate on green cement.

**48.7 Mt**

Egypt's cement output in 2019, the largest in Africa (USGS)

**98%**

utilisation of Egypt's cement plants in 2025

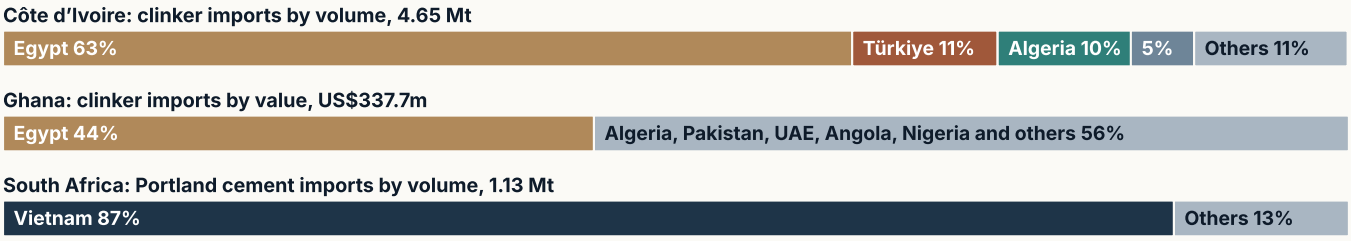
SUPPLY BY COAST

# Egypt is the largest clinker supplier to Côte d'Ivoire and Ghana; South Africa's imported cement comes from Vietnam

EXHIBIT 15

## Egypt supplies 63% of Côte d'Ivoire's imported clinker and 44% of Ghana's; Vietnam supplies 87% of South Africa's imported cement

Share of 2024 imports by origin, as recorded by the importing country




**Source:** UN Comtrade data through World Bank WITS: imports of HS 252310 by Côte d'Ivoire and Ghana and of HS 252329 by South Africa, 2024, accessed 2026. Shares are **Heirstone analysis**.

EXHIBIT 16

## Heirstone Cement and Steel Supply Table: among the origins we reviewed, Egypt is the largest clinker supplier to Africa by value and Türkiye the largest rebar supplier

2024 exports of clinker (HS 252310), grey Portland cement (HS 252329) and rebar (HS 721420) by origin, and the African share

| ORIGIN | DATA BASIS | CLINKER EXPORTS | CLINKER TO AFRICA | CEMENT EXPORTS | CEMENT TO AFRICA | REBAR TO AFRICA | MAIN AFRICAN BUYERS |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Egypt** | own return | US$483.7m | US$375.8m (77.7%) | US$346.5m | 64.3% of value | US$99.7m; US$170.6m in 2025 | Côte d'Ivoire, Ghana, Cameroon, Guinea; Libya, Sudan |
| **Algeria** | importers' returns | US$293.4m (4.71 Mt) | US$142.6m (47.0% of volume) | US$83.6m | 20.7% of volume | US$1.5m | Mauritania, Côte d'Ivoire, Ghana |
| **Türkiye** | own return | US$247.5m (5.96 Mt) | US$46.0m (21.8% of volume) | US$790.7m (13.6 Mt) | 2.2% of volume | US$312.4m | Côte d'Ivoire, Liberia; Ethiopia, Djibouti for rebar |
| **Morocco** | own return | US$44.0m (1.12 Mt) | US$32.1m (76.8% of volume) | US$2.7m | 99.9% of value | n/p | Guinea, Ghana, Benin, Mauritania |
| **Vietnam** | importers' returns | US$198.8m (3.54 Mt) | US$7.2m (2.0% of volume) | US$1,053.4m (16.3 Mt) | 11.2% of volume | n/p | South Africa, Mauritius, Madagascar |
| **China** | own return | n/p | n/p | n/p | n/p | US$205.4m | Guinea |
| **Nigeria (Dangote)** | company report, 2025 | 0.97 Mt | 100% | 1.4 Mt incl. clinker | 100% | n/p | Ghana, Cameroon; Niger and Togo by road |
| **Senegal** | own return | n/p | n/p | US$168.4m (2.11 Mt) | 100% of value | n/p | Mali (82% of volume), Gambia, Mauritania |

**Source:** UN Comtrade data through World Bank WITS, exporters' returns or, for Algeria and Vietnam, which did not report for 2024, importers' returns (mirror data), accessed 2026; Dangote Cement FY2025 earnings release. Egypt's volumes are omitted because Comtrade estimates them. African totals are **Heirstone analysis** summing all African partner rows.

West Africa's cement industry runs largely on imported clinker ground near the ports. Côte d'Ivoire imported 4.65 Mt in 2024, 2.93 Mt of it from Egypt, more than Egypt's own return shows (2.02 Mt), because Comtrade estimates Egypt's volumes from a fixed unit value. On value or importers' volumes, Egypt is the leading clinker supplier to Côte d'Ivoire and Ghana and to the grinding plants that Dangote, CIMAF, Heidelberg Materials and others run there.

Other producers sell differently: almost half of Türkiye's cement exports by value went to the United States, while Morocco sends three-quarters of its clinker to West Africa. East Africa grinds its own clinker: Kenya imported only 10,212 t in 2024.

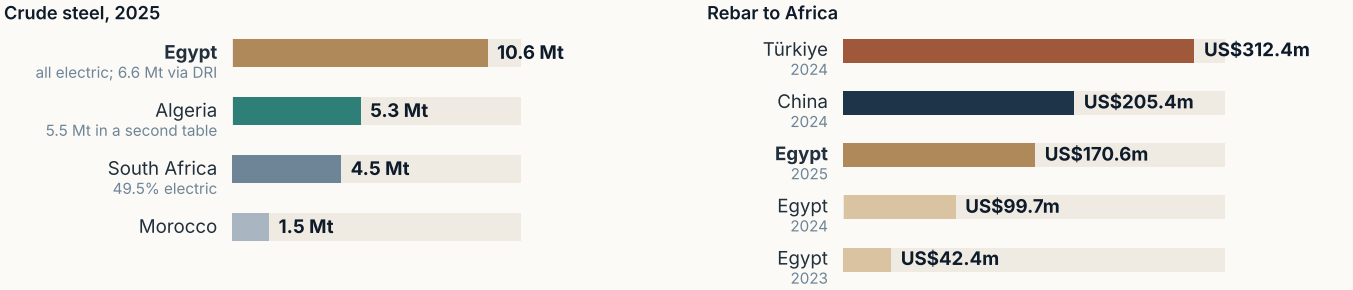
STEEL AND THE REGIONAL PRODUCERS

# Africa's largest steel producer makes all its steel in electric furnaces, and Nigeria is building a cement export industry of its own

EXHIBIT 17

## Egypt makes about twice as much steel as any other African producer, and its rebar sales to Africa quadrupled in two years

Left: crude steel production, million tonnes, 2025. Right: rebar exports to African buyers by origin, US$ million




**Source:** worldsteel production release (2026; 70 reporting countries) and World Steel in Figures 2026 (Algeria's second figure, electric share, DRI); UN Comtrade data through World Bank WITS, exports of HS 721420 by Türkiye, China and Egypt, accessed 2026. African totals are **Heirstone analysis**.

Egypt produced 10.6 Mt of crude steel in 2025, the most in Africa and nineteenth in the world, according to worldsteel; Algeria produced 5.3 Mt and South Africa 4.5 Mt. Egypt made 46% of Africa's steel on the 23.2 Mt total in worldsteel's production release and 36% on the 29.8 Mt in World Steel in Figures 2026. All of it was made in electric furnaces, 6.6 Mt from direct reduced iron. Ezz Steel, the largest producer, has 7 Mt a year of steel and 5 Mt of DRI capacity. Egypt exported US$1.82bn of iron and steel in 2025.

Egypt's rebar exports were US$315.7m in 2023, US$630.3m in 2024 and US$538.2m in 2025, and the African share rose from 13% to 32%: US$170.6m in 2025, led by Sudan, Libya, Kenya and Uganda. Türkiye remains the largest supplier among the origins we reviewed, with US$312.4m of rebar sold to Africa in 2024, led by Ethiopia and Djibouti; China sold US$205.4m, led by Guinea.

Inside Africa, Nigeria is the other materials power. Dangote Cement has 55.0 Mt a year of capacity in ten countries, 35.25 Mt of it in Nigeria. Its Nigerian exports rose 18.6% to 1.4 Mt, including 970,100 t of clinker for Cameroon and Ghana, and it opened a 3 Mt grinding plant in Côte d'Ivoire. It targets 80 Mt of capacity by 2030 and exports of 10 Mt each of cement and clinker. That clinker target is close to the 11 Mt of clinker that Titan Egypt's chief executive says Egypt exported in 2024.

Ownership is changing too. Huaxin Cement bought Holcim's 83.81% of Lafarge Africa, with 10.6 Mt of capacity, in 2025, which International Cement Review says makes it Africa's second-largest producer. BUA Cement has 17 Mt of capacity. Morocco's CIMAF had 13 grinding stations in ten African countries in 2021, and Heidelberg Materials operates in eight Sub-Saharan countries.

**10.6 Mt**

Egypt's crude steel output in 2025, Africa's largest

**4x**

growth in Egypt's rebar exports to Africa, 2023 to 2025

**55 Mt**

Dangote Cement's capacity in ten African countries; 80 Mt targeted by 2030

CHAPTER 6

# 06

# A carbon border on the Mediterranean



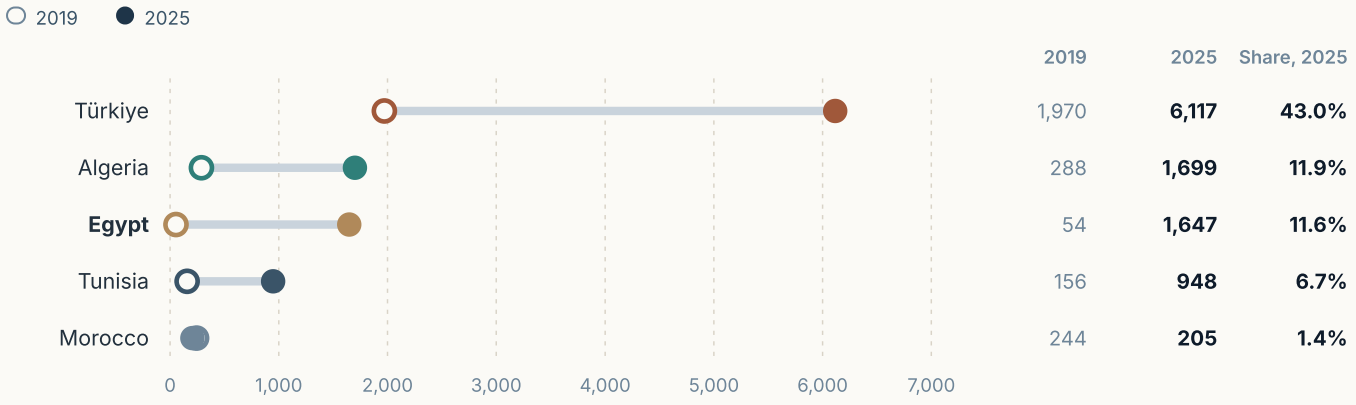
Since the start of 2026, EU importers of cement, iron and steel, aluminium, fertilisers, electricity and hydrogen have owed a carbon charge under the Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism (CBAM), after a reporting-only transition from 2023. The certificate price follows EU emissions trading auctions: €75.36 a tonne of CO2 for the first quarter of 2026, €75.28 for the second and €82.32 for the third. Certificates go on sale in 2027, when importers surrender them for 2026 imports.

Importers of less than 50 tonnes a year are exempt, which still keeps at least 99% of embedded emissions in scope. Without verified plant data, importers use country defaults marked up by 10% in 2026, 20% in 2027 and 30% from 2028; a carbon price paid at origin can be deducted.

EXHIBIT 18

## Five Mediterranean origins supplied three-quarters of the EU's imported cement and clinker in 2025, and Egypt's shipments grew thirty-fold from 2019

EU27 imports of cement and clinker (HS 2523) by origin, thousand tonnes, 2019 and 2025, and share of extra-EU imports in 2025




| | 2019 | 2025 | Share, 2025 |
|---|---|---|---|
| Türkiye | 1,970 | **6,117** | **43.0%** |
| Algeria | 288 | **1,699** | **11.9%** |
| **Egypt** | 54 | **1,647** | **11.6%** |
| Tunisia | 156 | **948** | **6.7%** |
| Morocco | 244 | **205** | **1.4%** |

**Source:** Eurostat Comext DS-045409, EU27 imports from extra-EU27, HS 2523 (updated 2026). Shares and the 74.6% total (10.62 Mt of 14.24 Mt) are **Heirstone analysis**.

For cement, CBAM is in practice a Mediterranean policy. The EU's imports of cement and clinker from outside the bloc rose from 9.33 Mt in 2023 to 14.24 Mt in 2025, and Türkiye, Algeria, Egypt, Tunisia and Morocco supplied 10.62 Mt, or 74.6%, of the 2025 total. Egypt grew fastest: from 54,080 t in 2019 to 1.65 Mt in 2025, most of it clinker. For Egypt, building materials are a small part of its trade in CBAM goods: cement sales to the EU were €90.2m in 2025 and bars and rods €122.5m, against €1.39bn of nitrogen fertilisers, a market in which Egypt supplied 44.3% of the EU's urea imports from outside the bloc.

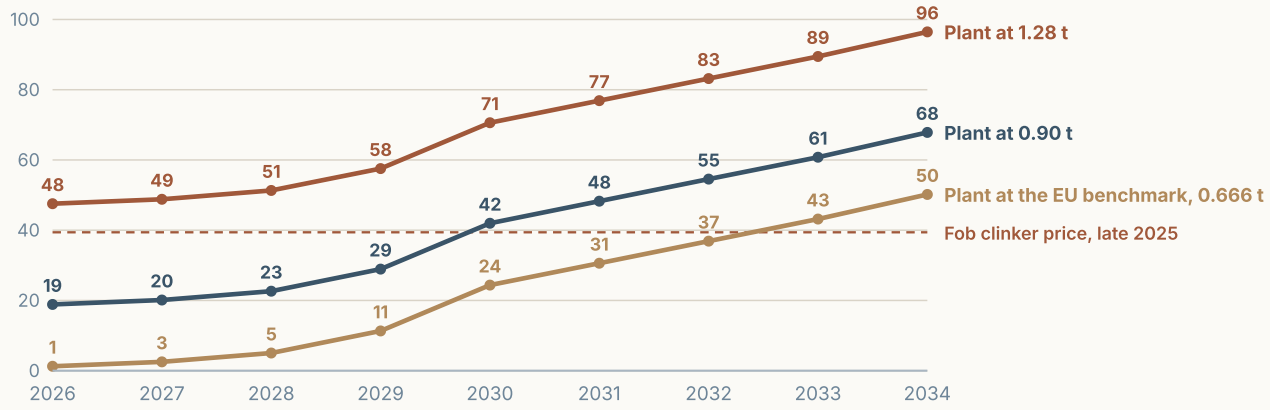
A BACK-LOADED CHARGE

# The charge is light in 2026 and steep by 2030; verified plant emissions will shape who keeps the EU market

EXHIBIT 19

## At the 2026 price, a benchmark plant pays €1.25 a tonne of clinker this year and about €24 in 2030; less efficient plants pay more than the fob price by then

Illustrative CBAM charge per tonne of clinker by emissions intensity, € per tonne, 2026 to 2034, at a constant certificate price of €75.36 and without default mark-ups




**Source:** Directive (EU) 2023/959 (CBAM factor); Global Cement (2026) for the 0.666 t benchmark; European Commission, CBAM certificate price (2026); Argus Media (2025) for fob prices, converted at the Eurostat 2025 average of US$1.13 per euro. 1.28 t: Algeria's clinker default in Implementing Regulation (EU) 2025/2621; 0.90 t: Moroccan default as reported by CBAM Guide, not confirmed in the regulation, used as an illustrative intensity. **Heirstone analysis.**

Importers pay on embedded emissions above the share of the benchmark still covered by EU free allocation. That share, the CBAM factor, is 97.5% in 2026, 90% in 2028 and 51.5% in 2030, and falls to zero in 2034. For grey clinker the benchmark is 0.666 t of CO2 per tonne; free allocation still covered 98.6% of EU cement and lime emissions in 2024.

The charge is therefore back-loaded. At the first-quarter 2026 price, a benchmark plant pays about €1.25 a tonne of clinker in 2026, €24 in 2030 and €50 in 2034; a plant at 0.90 t pays about €19 and €42. Turkish and Egyptian clinker was offered at US$44 to US$45 a tonne fob in late 2025, about €39 to €40, so by 2030 the charge on all but the most efficient plants would exceed that price.

Measured plant emissions will therefore weigh on competitiveness. Clinker defaults before mark-ups run from 1.28 t for Algeria to 0.90 t reported for Morocco by CBAM Guide, and the mark-ups penalise exporters who cannot document lower figures. Cement defaults include electricity, so cleaner grids help: renewables reached 45.5% of Morocco's installed capacity in 2025.

Steel is charged on direct emissions only, against hot-rolled coil benchmarks of 1.370 t for blast furnaces, 0.481 t for direct reduction with electric furnaces and 0.072 t for scrap. Egypt sits on the favourable side: all of its 2025 steel came from electric furnaces, and about 60% of its capacity uses direct reduction, which can in principle move from gas to hydrogen. Its sales of bars and rods to the EU rose from 20,495 t in 2019 to 228,531 t in 2025.

**0.481 t**

CO2 benchmark for DRI and electric-furnace steel, against 1.370 t for blast furnaces

**100%**

of Egypt's crude steel made by the electric route in 2025

**€30**

carbon-accounted premium a tonne for rebar in Europe (Platts, 2025)

WHERE THE TONNES COULD GO

# If Mediterranean clinker leaves the EU market, West Africa's grinding plants are a likely outlet

EXHIBIT 20

## If a quarter of the Mediterranean volume sold to the EU moved south, it would equal more than half of Côte d'Ivoire's clinker imports

Scenarios for cement and clinker redirected from the EU, against two African reference volumes; assumptions stated below

| CASE | SHARE OF 2025 EU-BOUND VOLUME REDIRECTED | MT A YEAR | EQUAL TO CÔTE D'IVOIRE'S 2024 CLINKER IMPORTS | EQUAL TO DANGOTE'S 2025 EXPORTS FROM NIGERIA |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Low** | 10% | 1.1 | 23% | 0.8x |
| **Central** | 25% | 2.7 | 57% | 1.9x |
| **High** | 50% | 5.3 | 114% | 3.8x |
| **Observed pace, first seven months of 2026, annualised** | 17% | 1.8 | 39% | 1.3x |

**Source:** Eurostat Comext DS-045409 (EU27 imports from Türkiye, Algeria, Egypt, Tunisia and Morocco, 2025, and first seven months of 2025 and 2026); UN Comtrade through WITS (Côte d'Ivoire, 2024); Dangote Cement FY2025 earnings release. Assumptions: the base is the 10.62 Mt the five origins sold to the EU in 2025; all redirected tonnes go to African buyers (an upper bound); African prices and demand are unchanged. The observed row annualises the five origins' fall in EU sales between the first seven months of 2025 and 2026, and includes the effect of stocking in late 2025. These are sensitivities, not forecasts. **Heirstone analysis.**

Argus Media expected CBAM to divert Mediterranean clinker from the EU and named Senegal, Cameroon, Togo, Liberia, Mauritania, Guinea, Ghana and Côte d'Ivoire as destinations, and Libya and Ghana for cement. Exhibit 20 measures how large such a shift could be. A tenth of the five origins' EU volume is about 1.1 Mt a year; a quarter is 2.7 Mt, more than half of Côte d'Ivoire's clinker imports and almost twice Dangote's exports from Nigeria.

The first seven months of 2026 give an early reading. The EU's cement and clinker imports from outside the bloc fell 20.8% by volume on the same months of 2025, and shipments from the five Mediterranean origins fell by about 1.05 Mt, a pace of about 1.8 Mt a year, between our low and central cases. Part of the fall reflects stocking ahead of the charge, and Algeria's shipments rose 5.5%.

For African buyers, more Mediterranean clinker would mean more competition among suppliers to their grinding plants, as Dangote targets 10 Mt of clinker exports by 2030. For producers, the EU rewards documented low emissions. Egypt is preparing on both fronts: dedicated bulk terminals for 45,000-tonne vessels at Dekheila and Sokhna are under study at US$20m to US$25m each, and its readiness programme, summarised alongside, aims to turn default values into verified ones.

### EGYPT'S READINESS

**PLAN**

National CBAM plan approved by the Cabinet in 2024, with a permanent committee for carbon reduction; voluntary carbon market launched in 2024.

**DATA**

Industrial emissions and energy registries, announced for 2025 and 2026, to help exporters document emissions.

**FINANCE**

Green Sustainable Industry programme of up to EGP 16bn (about US$325m at the 2025 average); €53.8m of AFD and EIB finance signed in 2025.

**CEMENT**

Arabian Cement: up to €25m from the EBRD (2025) for alternative fuels and Egypt's first hydrogen injection in cement, cutting 130,000 t of CO2 a year.

**HYDROGEN**

Egypt Green Hydrogen at Ain Sokhna: 100 MW electrolyser, Orascom Construction among the shareholders; 259,000 t of renewable ammonia contracted to Germany for 2027 to 2033.

CHAPTER 7

# 07 Region by region

Africa is several construction markets with different builders, financiers and suppliers. The coast a country faces largely shapes where its clinker comes from, and its budget and lenders shape who builds.

EXHIBIT 21

## Who builds, who pays and who supplies differs by region; Mediterranean clinker meets its most open demand in West and Central Africa

Summary by market, from the Ledger and the supply data in Chapters 2 to 6

| MARKET | WHO BUILDS THE LEDGER PROJECTS | HOW THEY ARE PAID FOR | CEMENT AND STEEL SUPPLY | WHAT CHANGES NEXT |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **NORTH AFRICA** | | | | |
| **Egypt** | Egyptian primes at home (Grand Egyptian Museum, Borg El Arab); European and Chinese partners on high-speed rail and the Iconic Tower | Public budgets; financing of the Ledger projects not published | Self-supplied and exporting: about 55 Mt of cement (FY2024/25) and 10.6 Mt of steel (2025) | Exports contractors and materials to Africa and the Gulf |
| **Algeria, Morocco, Tunisia, Libya** | CSCEC in Algeria; Egyptian firms on an oil field (Algeria), power lines (Morocco), desalination (Tunisia) and reconstruction (Libya) | State and client funds | Algeria and Morocco export clinker south; Libya is the largest buyer of Egyptian cement (US$146.4m, 2025) | EU-bound volumes from Algeria and Tunisia face the CBAM charge |
| **WEST AFRICA** | | | | |
| **Nigeria** | CCECC on railways and airport terminals; CHEC as builder and 52.5% owner of Lekki port | China Exim credit, federal funds, contractor equity | Self-sufficient: Dangote 35.25 Mt, BUA 17 Mt, Huaxin-Lafarge 10.6 Mt; 1.4 Mt exported (2025) | Nigerian clinker competes in Ghana and Cameroon |
| **Côte d'Ivoire, Ghana** | French consortium on Abidjan's metro; Egyptian water plants, flyover and roads | French government loan; Millennium Challenge Account | Imported clinker: Egypt 63% of Ivorian volume and 44% of Ghanaian value (2024) | Likely outlet for clinker leaving the EU |
| **Senegal, Sahel** | Turkish venues, airport and gas plant in Senegal; Egyptian solar in Burkina Faso | BOT concession; utility clients | Senegal exports 2.11 Mt of cement, 82% to Mali; Algerian clinker to Mauritania | Overland supply to landlocked markets |
| **CENTRAL AND EAST AFRICA** | | | | |
| **Central Africa** | Arab Contractors in Equatorial Guinea; Elsewedy in DR Congo; Orascom in Burundi | Government clients | Cameroon takes Egyptian and Nigerian clinker | Francophone franchise for Egyptian firms |
| **Tanzania, Kenya, Uganda** | Turkish and Chinese railways; Egyptian dam and roads; Chinese bridge and expressway | Turkish and Chinese credit, commercial loan, domestic funds, PPP | Integrated plants in Tanzania; Kenya imported only 10,212 t of clinker (2024); rebar from Egypt and Türkiye | African budgets keep the rail and power build-out open to all |
| **Ethiopia, Djibouti** | Chinese and Turkish railways; Italian dam | Italy's SACE for the dam; others not published | Türkiye's largest rebar buyers in Africa: Ethiopia US$78.8m, Djibouti US$49.1m | Dangote plans US$400m to double Ethiopian capacity |
| **SOUTHERN AFRICA** | | | | |
| **Angola, Zambia, Mozambique, Namibia, South Africa** | Chinese dams, bridge, port and airport; Egyptian power and roads; Korean bridge | China Exim; AfDB and JICA; EPC+F | Vietnam supplies 87% of South Africa's cement imports; Dangote plants in South Africa and Zambia | Contractor finance wins power; Asian cement on the Indian Ocean |

**Source:** Heirstone Africa Builders Ledger 2026; Heirstone Cement and Steel Supply Table 2026; Dangote Cement (2026); Arab Finance (2026); worldsteel (2026); UN Comtrade through WITS (2024, 2025). **Heirstone analysis.**

MARKET NOTES

# North Africa exports builders and materials; West and Central Africa buy both; East and Southern Africa build on mixed money

## North Africa

Egypt is the region's exporter of construction capacity: the largest cement and steel producer on the continent and home to five of ENR's Top 250 international contractors. Algeria is the swing supplier of clinker. Its industry minister puts the cement surplus at about 20 Mt a year, its producers say exports passed 10 Mt in 2024, and importers' returns show 47% of its clinker going to Africa; a 30% US surcharge applied to Algerian cement from 2025, according to Maghreb Émergent. Morocco's cement deliveries reached 14.8 Mt in 2025, up 8.2%, and Ciments du Maroc has about 8 Mt of capacity. Libya is the largest market for Egyptian cement and, through Derna, for Egyptian reconstruction work; the chairman of the African Federation of Construction Contractors' Associations put Egyptian reconstruction contracts in Libya at US$15bn in 2023.

## Francophone West and Central Africa

Côte d'Ivoire is the clinker hub of the Atlantic coast, importing 4.65 Mt in 2024 for its grinding plants, to which Dangote added 3 Mt of capacity in 2025. Its large projects draw on several kinds of money: a French government loan for the metro and the Millennium Challenge Account for the Koumassi flyover, while the sanitation ministry has contracted the Arab Contractors for six wastewater plants. Senegal shows the Turkish model at its clearest. Burkina Faso's utility has hired Elsewedy twice for solar plants. In Central Africa, Egyptian firms hold long franchises: about €1.5bn of Arab Contractors' work in Equatorial Guinea since 2003, Orascom's hydropower in Burundi and Elsewedy's substation in the DR Congo. These are natural markets for an Egyptian firm with francophone teams.

## Anglophone West Africa

Nigeria is self-sufficient in cement and is building an export business, while its railways and airport terminals were built by Chinese firms on China Exim credit. Ghana imported US$337.7m of clinker in 2024, 44% of it Egyptian, and both Dangote and Heidelberg Materials grind there.

## East Africa

Tanzania has more projects in the Ledger than any other country, eight, built by Turkish, Chinese and Egyptian primes on Turkish and Chinese credit, a commercial loan and domestic funds. Uganda signed Malaba-Kampala with a Turkish builder for about US$3bn, while the Arab Contractors build its district roads. Kenya's railway and expressway were Chinese-built, on China Exim credit and a PPP, and Kenya now imports little clinker. Ethiopia buys Turkish rebar, and Dangote plans US$400m to double its capacity there.

## Southern Africa

Angola has used both Chinese dam builders and Egyptian contractor finance: Elsewedy's two largest disclosed Angolan contracts, US$484m and €373m, are EPC+F. Zambia's Lusaka airport was built on China Exim credit and its Kazungula bridge on AfDB and JICA money. South Africa produced 4.5 Mt of steel in 2025 and buys most of its imported cement from Vietnam.

## The Gulf as competitor and financier

The Gulf competes with Africa for Egyptian contractors' capacity. Hassan Allam signed US$2bn of Saudi contracts in 2024, according to its chief executive, and Orascom is building a 3 GW plant at Qurayyah. Gulf capital also shapes African projects: Qatar Airways agreed in 2019 to take 60% of Rwanda's new Bugesera airport.

> *Egyptian builders won three of the seven open-money projects in the Ledger, in power, roads and oil.*

WHAT TO DO

# Recommendations by audience

If current trends hold, more of Africa's construction over the next decade will be paid for with African, multilateral and contractor-arranged money. Buyers who separate finance from the builder, look behind the prime contract and secure their materials from more than one coast should get better prices. Builders and producers who bring finance, a delivery record and verified low-carbon materials are best placed to win more of the work.

FOR

## Governments and procurement agencies

- Separate the choice of financier from the choice of builder where you can. All eight tied-credit projects in the Ledger went to the lender's own builders; compare each tied package with an open tender for the same scope.
- Use development-bank and budget money to widen the field: open money in the Ledger went to Korean, Turkish, Chinese and Egyptian builders.
- Publish contract values and financiers. Only 21 of the 60 Ledger projects have a published financier.
- Ask importers of clinker and rebar for verified plant emissions now; they will matter for any project seeking green finance.

FOR

## Developers and project sponsors

- Look behind the prime contractor: list who builds each part and whose equipment is installed, as at Julius Nyerere.
- Buy speed where the date has value. Summa delivered a 50,000-seat stadium in 17 months; price the schedule and the guarantee behind it.
- Contract cement and steel from at least two origins. On the Atlantic coast, Egyptian, Algerian, Turkish, Moroccan and Nigerian clinker now compete.
- Benchmark unit prices: US$4m to US$6m per kilometre for most standard-gauge sections in the Ledger.

FOR

## DFIs, lenders and investors

- Contractor-arranged finance is a growth market. Guarantee lines like Afreximbank's US$3bn of 2023 facilities let mid-sized firms bid for large African contracts.
- Fund the logistics of the new materials trade: grinding plants, bulk terminals and storage on the West African coast.
- Put CBAM's back-loaded cost into the credit models of Mediterranean cement and steel exporters to the EU: about €24 a tonne of clinker by 2030 even at the benchmark, at the 2026 price.

FOR

## Contractors and materials producers

- Sell the route as well as the price. Egyptian firms win most through partnership and presence; pair contracts with finance and with Egyptian cement and steel.
- Carry repeat-client franchises into francophone markets, where Egyptian firms already work from Equatorial Guinea to Côte d'Ivoire.
- Producers: verify plant-level emissions, keep moving from clinker to finished cement, and market electric-route steel as low-carbon rebar.

WHAT TO WATCH

### 2027

First CBAM certificates sold and surrendered for 2026 imports; default mark-up rises to 20%.

### 2028

Default mark-up reaches 30%; proposed extension of CBAM to about 180 downstream steel and aluminium products.

### 2030

CBAM factor falls to 51.5%: about €24 a tonne of clinker even at the benchmark, at the 2026 price. Dangote's 80 Mt capacity and 10 Mt clinker export targets fall due.

### Every year

Chinese loan commitments, AfDB and budget-funded awards, and Egyptian contractors' share of business abroad.

THE BUYER'S TEST

# Eight questions before signing a contractor and a materials source

The Five Routes describe how builders win. The buyer's test turns them round: these are the questions we would put to any offer for a large African project, whether we were advising the government, the developer or the lender.

Each question rests on evidence in this report. Most cost little to ask at tender and a great deal to answer after signing.

**How Heirstone works on construction markets**

We help governments, developers and investors in the Middle East and Africa plan and procure large projects: market and demand studies, highest-and-best-use and site selection, feasibility and business models (DCF, IRR, NPV and Monte Carlo testing), procurement and contractor benchmarking, and materials and supply-chain analysis of the kind in this report.

**Get in touch**
info@heirstoneconsulting.com
heirstoneconsulting.com

## 1 Who is paying, and does the money arrive with a builder attached?

In the Ledger, tied credit went to the lender's own builders every time. If it does, compare the whole package with an open tender.

## 2 Is the unit price in line?

Most standard-gauge sections in the Ledger cost US$4m to US$6m per kilometre and the large dams US$1.3m to US$2.8m per megawatt, as published. Ask why an offer differs.

## 3 What finance does the builder control, and at what cost?

EPC+F and guarantee lines can open a project, as in Angola. Price the finance separately from the works.

## 4 Has the builder delivered for this client or network before?

Presence explains 13 of the 60 Ledger awards. A team and plant already in the country save time and mobilisation cost.

## 5 Who actually builds which part?

List the subcontractors and equipment suppliers behind the prime, and who carries the risk if one of them fails.

## 6 What is the date worth?

Where an event or a season sets the deadline, a fast-track builder is worth a premium; pay it against a completion guarantee backed by a bond or penalties.

## 7 Where will the cement and steel come from?

Name at least two origins, the port and the landed price. Egyptian clinker is the largest source for Côte d'Ivoire and Ghana.

## 8 Can the supplier document its emissions?

Verified plant data will matter for green finance and for any later sale into Europe, where the CBAM charge rises every year to 2034.

NOTES, SOURCES AND DEFINITIONS

# Notes

## Definitions

**ENR Top 250:** Engineering News-Record's annual ranking of the largest international contractors by revenue earned outside their home country; each edition reports the previous year. **Prime contractor:** the firm or joint venture holding the main contract. **Builder nationality:** the home country of the prime contractor or of the lead partner. **Tied credit:** a loan from a lender of one country that is used to pay a builder from that country. **EPC+F:** engineering, procurement and construction with finance arranged by the contractor. **Clinker:** the intermediate product of a cement kiln, ground with additives into cement. **CBAM:** the EU Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism. **DRI:** direct reduced iron. **fob:** free on board.

## Method

The Heirstone Africa Builders Ledger 2026 holds 39 landmark projects since about 2015 and 21 projects of Egyptian contractors elsewhere in Africa, compiled from public sources; it is a purposive sample. Values are as published. Euro values are converted at the Eurostat or World Bank annual average for the year shown; Tanzanian shilling and rand values at the World Bank annual average (TSh2,597.9 per US$ for 2024, the latest published; R14.448 for 2019). EGP flows are converted at the World Bank annual average (45.30 per US$ in 2024, 49.23 in 2025) and EGP order books at US Treasury quarter-end rates (30.85 in mid-2023, 47.6 at end-2025); because the rate moved between those dates, growth is shown in US dollars. Multi-year and forward-looking EGP and euro totals are not converted. Trade data are customs values; Egypt's Comtrade volumes are estimated by Comtrade, so Egypt is compared on value or importers' volumes. Where sources conflict we show the range or the lower figure. Derived figures are labelled Heirstone analysis.

## The Five Routes

Each Ledger project is assigned to one route, in this order: finance, where the financier is the builder's home-country lender or the builder itself (EPC+F, PPP, equity or concession); speed, where a published fast-track date or early completion defines the award; partnership, where the prime contract is held by a consortium or joint venture; presence, where the builder has repeat work for the same client, network or country in the Ledger or its sources; and price, for open tenders paid for by budgets, development banks or donors. Projects with none of these published are unclassified.

## Use of this report

This report is published for general information. It is not investment, legal, procurement or valuation advice and should not be relied on as such. It records public information about contractors and projects and makes no assessment of any firm's performance on any contract. © Heirstone Consulting L.L.C-FZ, 2026. Images are illustrative.

### 1 WHEN THE LENDER PICKS THE BUILDER

ENR Top 250 International Contractors (2016, 2017 editions); ENR figures as reported by CHINCA via The Paper (2025), Qianzhan Industry Research and Shifair (2022) and SAIS-CARI Working Paper 47 (2021); Boston University GDP Center, Chinese Loans to Africa Database, Policy Briefs 023 (2024) and 028 (2026); South China Morning Post (2021, 2024); Construction Briefing (2023); China Daily (2023); Xinhua Finance citing China's Ministry of Commerce (2025); Caixin Global (2025); Deloitte, Africa Construction Trends 2018 to 2021 and Deloitte Insights (2019).

### 2 THE LEDGER AND 3 FIVE ROUTES

Railway Gazette International (2022); RailwayPRO (2022, 2023); Railway Technology; Yapı Merkezi; International Railway Journal (2023); Ahram Online (2026); Africanews (2022); Daily News Tanzania (2025); Construction Review Online (2021); Maritimafrica (2023); The Citizen (2018, 2019); TanzaniaInvest (2022, 2025); Egypt Today (2026); Xinhua (2026); ENR (2016, 2018); The Independent Uganda (2024); Renewable Energy World (2017); Sudan Tribune (2016); Enerdata (2021); CTBUH; Chatham House (2020); Orascom Construction; Al Gomhuria (2025); AIBD; Daily Sabah (2022); Summa; IFC Disclosures (2024); KT Press (2016); Zambia Airports Corporation (2020); Vanguard (2018); Al Jazeera (2019); Horn Affairs (2011); Club of Mozambique; Voyages d'Affaires (2019); Republic of Türkiye Ministry of Trade; Turkish Contractors Association (TMB) reports (2025, 2026); TRT Haber and Anadolu Agency (2018).

### 4 EGYPT'S BUILDERS ABROAD

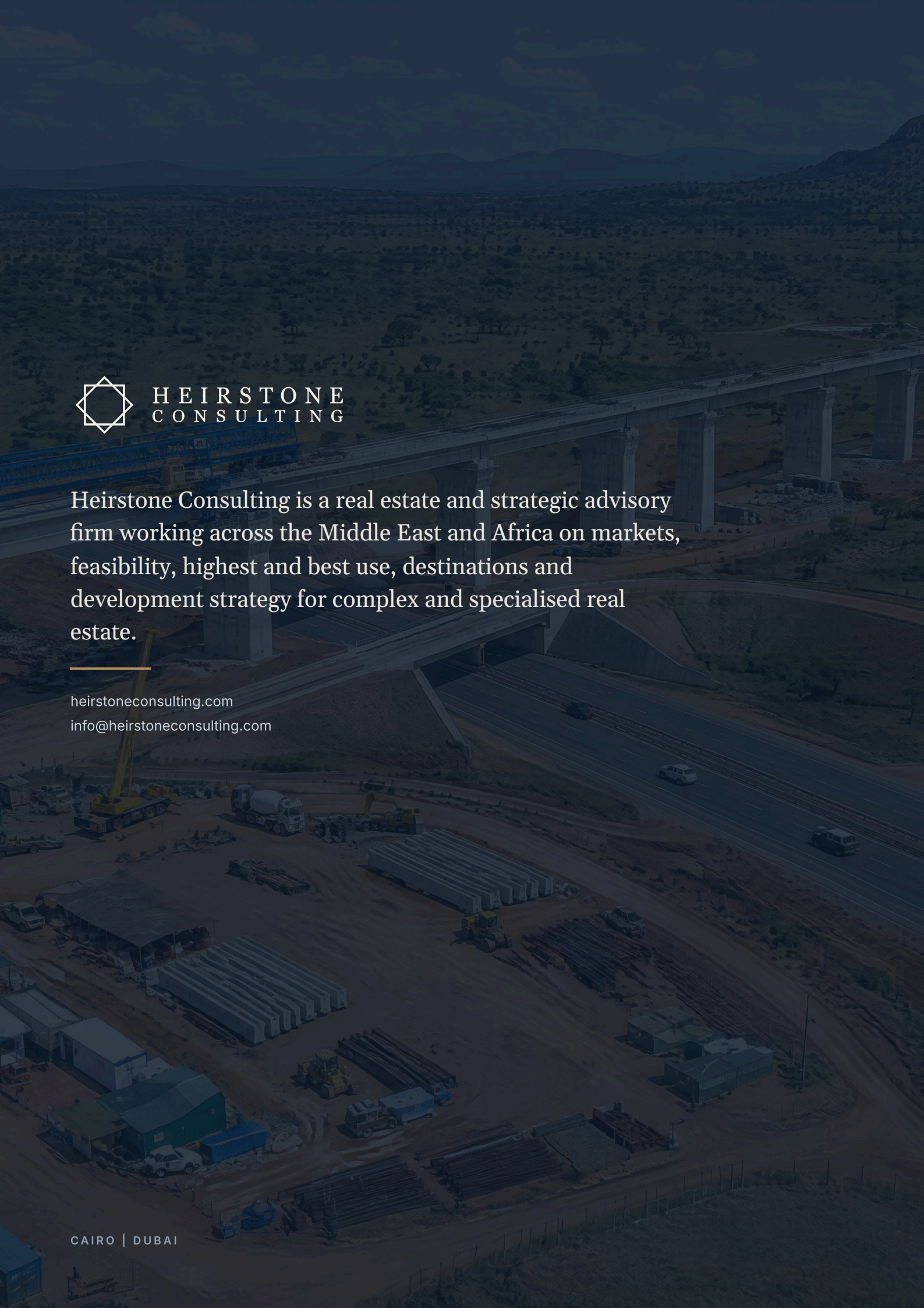
The Arab Contractors website and news releases (2012 to 2026); Elsewedy Electric FY2025, 2Q2023, 1Q2025 and 2Q2025 earnings releases and project pages; Decypha (2026); Orascom Construction FY2025 and H1 2026 results, Annual Report 2023, project pages and ENR release (2026); EnterpriseAM (2024, 2025, 2026); Forbes Middle East (2026); Hassan Allam Holding; Billionaires.Africa (2026); Sharikat Mubasher (2024, 2025); Daily News Egypt (2025); Amwal Al Ghad (2016, 2017, 2023, 2025); MEED (2025); Invest-Gate (2023, 2026); Business Today Egypt (2023, 2024); Cairo Governorate (2025); Embassy of Egypt in Washington (2018); Zawya citing the Ministry of Planning (2026); Oxford Business Group (2019); CairoScene; World Bank WDI; US Treasury reporting rates.

### 5 CEMENT AND STEEL

UN Comtrade data through World Bank WITS (HS 2523 and 721420, 2020 to 2025); Arab Finance via Zawya (2026); Erem Business (2025); Banker (2026); Global Cement (2025); S&P Global Commodity Insights (2025); EnterpriseAM (2026); US Geological Survey, Mineral Commodity Summaries 2026 and 2019 Minerals Yearbook; Heidelberg Materials; Ciments du Maroc (2025); Le Matin and Infomédiaire (2026); CemNet and International Cement Review (2024, 2025); Dzair Tube (2025); Radio Algérienne; Maghreb Émergent (2026); ObservAlgérie (2025); Dangote Cement FY2025 earnings release and presentation; The Guardian Nigeria (2025); IFC (2021); Khusoko (2025); Bloomberg HT (2025); OYAK Çimento (2025); worldsteel (2026); Ezz Steel.

### 6 A CARBON BORDER ON THE MEDITERRANEAN AND 7 REGION BY REGION

European Commission DG TAXUD; Regulation (EU) 2023/956 and 2025/2083; Directive (EU) 2023/959; Implementing Regulations (EU) 2025/2621 and 2026/1740; ICAP (2025); Eurometal (2025); Global Cement (2025, 2026); European Topic Centre on Climate Change Mitigation (2025); Instrat (2026); Eurostat Comext DS-045409; Argus Media (2025); S&P Global Commodity Insights (2025); CBAM Guide; GreenSutra; World Bank (2025); Al-Ahram Weekly (2025); Amwal Al Ghad (2025); CemNet (2025); Scatec (2024); Hydronews (2026); Deloitte Middle East; EBRD (2025); IEA PVPS.



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